In-Band Lattice Zero-Knowledge Proofs for Compressed-Domain H.264 Video Steganography

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***Abstract*—Proof-carrying steganography hides a payload in a cover medium together with a zero-knowledge proof about it, so that a verifier can check a claim from the medium alone. Existing systems either rely on pairing- or discrete-logarithm-based SNARKs, which do not survive quantum adversaries, or deliver the proof beside the medium, where it is easily stripped or swapped. We present a system that embeds a lattice zero-knowledge proof directly in the CAVLC residuals of an H.264 Baseline bitstream and verifies it from the received video, without side files, metadata boxes or access to the cover. The proof is a Fiat–Shamir-with-aborts proof of knowledge of an opening of a BDLOP commitment, instantiated at an estimated core-SVP level of 140 bits classical and 127 bits quantum for binding (164/150 bits for hiding). Its statement binds a carrier-normalized digest of the video, the verifier-recomputed carrier positions, a one-use verifier challenge and an issuer-signed relation registry; carrier normalization breaks the circularity between a proof and the video that contains it. Two modes are supported: a 8 165-byte envelope proving possession of a registered credential, and a 14 885-byte envelope committing to a hidden payload that can later be disclosed or linked to another commitment. On standard CIF and 4CIF sequences every completed run verified from the stego video alone and, where tested, rejected replayed sessions and single-bit tampering; luma PSNR on modified frames is 40.0–45.4 dB[TODO: v2 measurement]. Targeted classical steganalysis does not separate cover and stego, whereas a learned per-frame detector reaches a detection error of 0.40[TODO: v2 measurement] across clips, which we report as a limitation. We state precisely what the proof does and does not establish.**

***Index Terms*—Video steganography, H.264/AVC, CAVLC, zero-knowledge proofs, lattice-based cryptography, post-quantum cryptography, steganalysis.**

I. Introduction

COMPRESSED-DOMAIN video steganography modifies the syntax elements of an encoded stream, such as quantized transform coefficients or their entropy codes, instead of decoding and re-encoding pixels. It keeps the stream standard-compliant, avoids re-compression artefacts and, for H.264/AVC, has a long literature [1]–[3]. A recent line of work attaches cryptographic evidence to media: a zero-knowledge proof that a hidden or withheld value satisfies a relation, so that a verifier learns that a claim holds without learning the value [4]–[9]. Combining the two gives *proof-carrying steganography*: the medium carries a hidden envelope that a verifier can check from the medium alone.

Two problems remain open for video. First, the proof systems used in this setting are pre-quantum: pairing-based SNARKs such as Groth16 [10], or discrete-logarithm-based folding schemes. Their proofs are small and easy to hide, but their soundness and the hiding of the commitments they prove about rest on discrete-logarithm-type assumptions that a large quantum computer breaks. Media evidence is often expected to remain checkable for years, so it is worth asking what a post-quantum alternative costs in a channel whose capacity is measured in kilobits per hundred frames.

Second, where the proof lives matters. A proof in a side file or a metadata box (as in content-credential manifests [11]) is removed by any re-muxing tool and can be swapped between videos. Moving the proof into the bitstream creates a circularity: the proof should bind the video, yet it cannot depend on a hash of a bitstream that contains the proof itself.

This paper addresses both problems for H.264 Baseline (CAVLC) video. Our contributions are:

- **An in-band design.** A lattice zero-knowledge proof travels inside H.264 CAVLC residuals and is verified from the stego video alone, with no side file, SEI message or cover. A *carrier-normalized* video commitment, computed with every carrier coefficient replaced by a canonical value and with carrier positions fixed from a placeholder envelope of the final length, removes the proof/video circularity (Section V).
- **A verifier-built statement.** The Fiat–Shamir statement binds the recomputed video commitment, the recomputed carrier positions, a one-use verifier challenge, and a relation registry signed by an issuer with ML-DSA-65 [12]. The verifier never reads a statement field from the video, which gives replay protection and anchors trust at the verifier.
- **Two proof modes and linkage.** A registered mode proves possession of an issuer-registered credential (8 165-byte envelope), and an in-band mode commits to a hidden payload of up to 766 bytes (14 885-byte envelope) that can later be disclosed or linked, by an equality proof, to another video or to a credential without being revealed.
- **A concrete, reproducible instantiation and evaluation.** We give a parameter set with core-SVP estimates and known-answer vectors, and we evaluate capacity, end-to-end embedding and video-only verification, decoded quality, classical and learned steganalysis, the choice of carrier, and the cost relative to Groth16, ML-DSA and a lattice zkSNARK (Sections VII–VIII).

We are explicit about the limits (Section IX): soundness is relaxed, the security argument is in the classical random-oracle model, the implementation is neither audited nor constant time, and a learned per-frame detector does separate cover and stego better than chance.

II. Related work

A. Proof-carrying and provenance media

PhotoProof [4] introduced cryptographic image authentication that survives a set of permissible transformations, using proof-carrying data over a signed original. ZK-IMG [5], VerITAS [6] and VIMz [7] prove image transformations with SNARKs, lookup arguments or folding schemes, and Eva [8] proves the authenticity of lossily encoded (e.g. H.264) videos with folding-based incrementally verifiable computation and a 448-byte proof. These systems target provenance of edits from an attested capture; the proof is an object delivered with the medium, and their assumptions are pre-quantum. Content credentials [11] attach signed provenance manifests as metadata, which survive only as long as the container keeps them. Closest to us in placement is ZK-WAGON [9], which embeds a zk-SNARK about an image-generation model into the generated image by spatial-domain LSB steganography; it is image-domain, embeds a gzip-compressed Halo2 proof of about 100 kB in the pixel LSBs, and relies on a pre-quantum SNARK. Adelsbach and Sadeghi [13] proved the presence of a watermark in zero knowledge, which is the converse problem (a proof *about* hidden data, kept outside it). To our knowledge no prior system carries a lattice zero-knowledge proof inside a compressed video bitstream and verifies it from the stream alone; we make no provenance claim of the kind PhotoProof or Eva make.

B. Compressed-domain H.264 steganography and steganalysis

Surveys [1]–[3] classify H.264 schemes by the syntax they modify: intra-prediction modes, motion vectors, quantized DCT coefficients and the entropy-coding layer. Coefficient schemes must control *intra-frame distortion drift*, the propagation of a modified block into intra-predicted neighbours [14]. Within CAVLC, the signs of trailing ± 1 coefficients ("trailing ones") can be flipped without changing the code length [15]; we compare this carrier with the magnitude-parity carrier we adopt (Section VIII-E). Video steganalysis [16] has concentrated on motion-vector embedding [17]; for all-intra streams the natural attacks are image-steganalysis features applied to decoded frames, such as spatial rich models with ensemble classifiers [18], [19] and CNN detectors [20], together with targeted histogram attacks on the modified domain [21], [22]. Evidence pooled over many frames of one video is stronger than per-frame evidence [23], a point we return to in Section IX.

C. Lattice zero-knowledge proofs

BDLOP commitments [24] with Fiat–Shamir-with-aborts openings [25], [26] are the basis of the exact and linear/product proofs of Attema et al. [27], Esgin et al. [28] and Lyubashevsky et al. [29], implemented in LaZer [30]; ML-DSA [12], [31] uses the same masking-and-rejection technique for signatures. Succinct lattice arguments, including LaBRADOR [32], LatticeFold [33], RoKoko [34] and SALSAA [35], target proof size for large relations; the versions we could evaluate disable zero knowledge in their reported configurations, prove knowledge soundness only, or (for folding) do not provide a standalone zero-knowledge prover. Designated-verifier lattice zkSNARKs [36], [37] are compact, but the oblivious LWE-sampling assumption used in the analysis of the standard-model constructions, including ISW21, is invalidated against quantum adversaries [38] (without an attack on the constructions themselves). We evaluated these candidates as backends against four gates (zero knowledge, expressibility of the verifier-built statement, runnability on the target host, and fit in the measured carrier capacity); none passed all four, which motivates the small, self-contained BDLOP opening proof used here. The relation we need, knowledge of one commitment opening bound to a statement, is exactly the one the BDLOP opening proof covers.

III. Background

a) H.264 CAVLC: In the Baseline profile [39], [40], the residual of each 4×4 block is entropy-coded with CAVLC: a `coeff_token` giving the number of non-zero coefficients and of trailing ones (up to three final ± 1 values in reverse zig-zag order), one raw sign bit per trailing one, variable-length level codes for the remaining coefficients with an adaptive suffix length, and run-length codes for the zeros. The context of `coeff_token` depends on the number of non-zero coefficients in neighbouring blocks, so a change that alters that number propagates to the coding of later blocks. In intra slices each block is also a prediction reference for its neighbours, which is the origin of intra drift.

b) BDLOP commitments: Let $\mathcal{R}_q = \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/(X^N + 1)$ with N a power of two and $q \equiv 5 \pmod 8$ prime, so that $X^N + 1$ splits into two irreducible factors and every non-zero element of small norm, in particular every difference of two challenges, is invertible [41]. With public $B_1 = [I_n \,|\, B_1'] \in \mathcal{R}_q^{n \times k}$, $b_2 = [0^n \,|\, 1 \,|\, b_2'] \in \mathcal{R}_q^{1 \times k}$ and $k = n + \lambda + 1$, a commitment to $m \in \mathcal{R}_q$ with ternary randomness r is $t_1 = B_1 r$, $t_2 = \langle b_2, r \rangle + m$. It is computationally hiding under Module-LWE and binding under Module-SIS [24], [42].

c) Fiat–Shamir with aborts: The opening proof is a Σ-protocol in which the prover masks the response $z = y + cr$ with a uniform y and aborts unless z lies in a range that makes its distribution independent of r [25], [26]. It is made non-interactive with the Fiat–Shamir transform [43]. The original reprogramming argument for this transform had a gap that was fixed by Barbosa et al. [44] and Devevey et al. [45]; quantum-random-oracle results for Fiat–Shamir [46], [47] are generic and not tight for our setting.

IV. System and threat model

a) Roles: An *issuer* publishes a relation registry signed with ML-DSA-65. Each registry record pins a proof suite, the hash of the verification key (including, in registered mode, the holder's credential commitment), the parameter-set identifier and a policy hash over the codec policy and the carrier profile; the registry has an epoch. A *holder* owns a payload or a credential and produces the stego video. A *verifier* issues one-use session challenges, receives videos and

decides. The *adversary* observes all videos and challenges, replays, edits, re-encodes and re-embeds videos, runs its own holder instances, and performs steganalysis.

b) Trust: The verifier trusts only (i) the issuer public key, (ii) a minimum registry epoch (its rollback floor), (iii) the parameter set and carrier profile it is configured with, and (iv) its own session store. Nothing read from the video is trusted before verification succeeds. The holder and verifier share a symmetric carrier-ordering (stego) key when undetectability is required; the key can instead be derived from public configuration (Section V-G).

c) Goals: (G1) *Soundness bound to video and session*: if the verifier accepts, then whoever produced the video knew a (relaxed) opening of the bound commitment, for exactly this carrier-normalized video, carrier layout, registry entry and session. (G2) *Zero knowledge*: the video reveals nothing about the payload or the opening beyond the statement. (G3) *Integrity*: any change to non-carrier syntax, and any change to the envelope bytes carried by the carriers, is rejected. (Changes to a few carrier bits that hold chunk-framing fields are currently not all rejected; see Section IX.) (G4) *Replay resistance*: an envelope is accepted at most once, and only for a challenge the verifier issued and has not consumed. (G5) *Linkage and disclosure*: a holder can later show that two commitments hide the same payload, or open a commitment to a chosen party. (G6) *Undetectability* against an adversary without the stego key, measured empirically by steganalysis.

d) Non-goals: The proof does not establish that the payload is true, that a camera recorded the video, that an encoder ran correctly, or who the creator is in in-band mode (anyone holding a session challenge can produce an in-band proof about a fresh commitment; identity requires registered mode). The channel is fragile by design: re-encoding or transcoding destroys the envelope, and verification then fails closed. Robustness is not a goal.

V. Construction

Figure 1 summarizes the embed and verify flows. The proof system is specified in Section V-D; the remaining subsections describe how its statement is tied to the H.264 stream.

A. Carriers

In every eligible luma 4×4 block of an IDR slice, the carrier is the first AC coefficient in zig-zag order with $|level| \geq 4$ that is not a trailing one. One bit is written into the least-significant bit of its magnitude by a change of ±1, keeping the sign; the coefficient stays eligible and, because the selection rule is also required to be *rank-stable* (no earlier candidate becomes eligible after the flip), a blind extractor that applies the same rule to the stego stream finds the same position. A block is used only if its re-encoding with the modified carrier round-trips through the CAVLC parser of the rewritten slice (*patchability* check), and at most one coefficient per block is modified. The embedder writes the bits by re-encoding the affected blocks and rewriting the slice payload, which may change its length. An alternative profile uses the sign of a trailing one as the carrier (Section VIII-E).

B. Carrier layout and the carrier-normalized commitment

The stream is divided into segments of $F = 100$ frames. The envelope is framed into chunks of a fixed size (a 23-byte header with magic, version, index, count, total and chunk sizes and a CRC-32 of the chunk body) and one chunk is embedded per segment. Within a segment, carrier positions are ordered by a keyed permutation; the ordering key is derived with HMAC-SHA-256 from the stego key. Let P be the ordered list of global carrier positions used by all chunks.

The circularity is broken by fixing everything the statement depends on *before* the proof exists. The embedder first frames a *placeholder* envelope of exactly the final length; this determines the chunk sizes and hence P. It then computes, for each segment, the SHA-256 digest of the segment bitstream with every carrier coefficient in P replaced by a canonical value (magnitude with its least-significant bit cleared, sign kept; a sign carrier is set to $+1$), and combines the segment digests into D with a domain-separated hash. The video commitment is

$$V = \text{SHA-256}(dom_V \,\|\, D),$$

with the domain tag dom_V = zkstego/video-zk/video-commitment/v1. After proving, the embedder checks that the real envelope produces exactly the placeholder's chunk layout and aborts otherwise. Because D normalizes exactly the positions that carry the envelope, it is the same before and after embedding; any change outside the carriers changes D, and any change of an envelope byte invalidates the proof or the statement. The framing fields themselves are a partial exception (Section IX).

C. Statement

The Fiat–Shamir statement x is the fixed-width (274-byte) encoding

$$x = ver \,\|\, rel \,\|\, pid \,\|\, root \,\|\, epoch \,\|\, N_s \,\| \\ codec \,\|\, profile \,\|\, |P| \,\|\, \mathsf{H}(P) \,\|\, V,$$

with a 16-bit version, 64-bit epoch and carrier count, and 32-byte values otherwise: relation identifier, parameter-set identifier, registry root, session challenge, codec-policy identifier, carrier-profile identifier (a hash of the carrier contract, segment length, chunk size, envelope length and mode), carrier-position hash and video commitment. The verifier builds x only from its pinned configuration and from values it recomputes from the received stream.

D. Proof system

Algorithm 1 gives the opening proof and its verification for statement x and commitment $t = (t_1, t_2)$; H is SHAKE-256 with domain separation and length prefixes, and $\mathsf{SampleInBall}$ is the ML-DSA-style sampler that outputs $c \in \mathcal{R}_q$ with exactly κ coefficients in $\{\pm1\}$ and the rest zero. The masks are derived deterministically from fresh entropy, the statement, the commitment and the witness (hedged), so a mask is never reused across statements. Nothing from a rejected attempt leaves the prover. The equality proof used for linkage runs

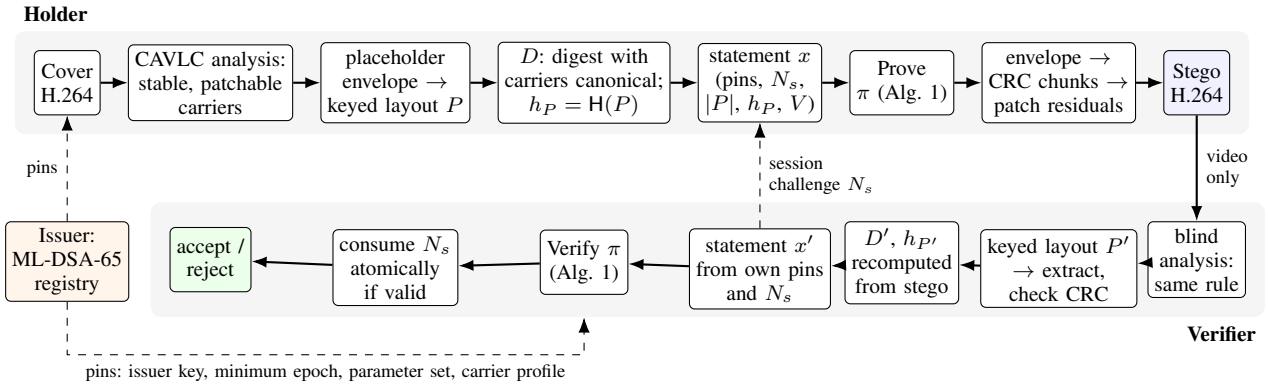


Fig. 1. Embedding (top) and video-only verification (bottom). Carrier positions and the carrier-normalized digest D are fixed from a placeholder envelope of the final length before the proof is computed, so the statement can bind them without depending on the proof bits. The verifier recomputes every statement field from the stego video and its own pinned configuration.

Algorithm 1 Opening proof (prover) and verification.

Prove(pid, x, t, r) ▷ $B = \gamma - \kappa - 1$
require $\|r\|_\infty \le 1$ and $B_1 r = t_1$
$K \leftarrow$ SHA3-256$(\mathit{entropy} \,\|\, x \,\|\, t \,\|\, r)$
for $i = 1, \ldots, 512$ **do**
  $y \leftarrow$ uniform in $[-\gamma+1, \gamma]^{kN}$ from $\mathsf{H}(\texttt{mask} \,\|\, K \,\|\, i)$
  $w \leftarrow B_1 y$
  $s \leftarrow \mathsf{H}(\texttt{fs} \,\|\, pid \,\|\, |x| \,\|\, x \,\|\, t \,\|\, w)$ ▷ 32 bytes
  $c \leftarrow \mathsf{SampleInBall}(s)$; $z \leftarrow y + cr$
  if $\|z\|_\infty \le B$ **then return** $\pi = (s, \mathrm{Pack}(z + B))$
return $\perp$ ▷ probability $< 2^{-156}$

Verify(pid, x, t, π)
parse $\pi = (s, z)$; reject unless $|\pi|$ is exact, every packed value lies in $[0, 2B]$ and padding bits are zero
$c \leftarrow \mathsf{SampleInBall}(s)$; $w' \leftarrow B_1 z - c\, t_1$
return $s = \mathsf{H}(\texttt{fs} \,\|\, pid \,\|\, |x| \,\|\, x \,\|\, t \,\|\, w')$

TABLE I
PARAMETER SET `BDLOP-OPEN-128-V2` AND CORE-SVP ESTIMATES (CRYSTALS SECURITY-ESTIMATES, COMMIT `75C26949`; M-LWE DUAL HYBRID FROM THE LATTICE-ESTIMATOR, COMMIT `E4333D9`).

N, q	256, $2^{30} - 35$ ($q \equiv 5 \bmod 8$)
n, λ, k	6, 7, 14
κ, γ, B	60, 2^{17}, $2^{17} - 61$
Challenge space	2^{257}
Commitment / opening proof	6 720 B / 8 096 B
Acceptance per attempt	0.191
Equality (linkage) proof	16 160 B
Max. in-band payload	766 B
M-SIS ($\ell_\infty \le 8\kappa B \approx 2^{25.9}$)	$\beta = 480$: 140 / 127 bits
M-LWE (rank λ, $n{+}1$ samples)	dual hybrid $\beta = 564$ / 567: 164 / 150 bits
(primal uSVP)	$\beta = 580$: 169 / 153 bits

β: BKZ block size; core-SVP, classical / quantum.

two copies of the protocol with a common challenge and adds $u = \langle b_2, y_a - y_b \rangle$ to the hash, which the verifier recomputes as $\langle b_2, z_a - z_b \rangle - c\,(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b})$.

Table I lists the production parameter set. With uniform masking the accepted response is exactly uniform on $[-B, B]^{kN}$, which gives zero knowledge without a Gaussian sampler; the price is a larger extracted norm, so binding is estimated for the ℓ_∞ bound $8\kappa B$ rather than reused from [24]. The per-attempt acceptance probability is $((2B+1)/2\gamma)^{kN} \approx 0.191$ (5.23 expected attempts; 4.68 measured over 50 runs with `bdlop-open-128-v1`**[TODO: v2 measurement]**). Core-SVP costs were computed with the CRYSTALS estimation scripts [48], ignoring reduction losses as for ML-DSA. An independent cross-check with the lattice-estimator [49], [50] (commit `e4333d9`, same core-SVP model) reproduces the M-SIS estimate ($\beta = 480$, 140/127 bits) and the primal M-LWE estimate ($\beta = 580$, 169/154 bits; 169/153 with the CRYSTALS scripts). Its dual-hybrid attack on M-LWE is slightly cheaper ($\beta = 564$, $2^{164.9}$ classical; $\beta = 567$, $2^{150.3}$ quantum), so we take 164/150 bits for hiding (Table I). The quantum binding estimate, 127 bits, is just below 128. The ℓ_2 relaxation of the binding bound exceeds q, so binding rests on the ℓ_∞ estimate. Under the estimator's default cost model, every attack on either instance costs at least 2^{170}. The earlier set `bdlop-open-128-v1` ($\lambda = 6$, $k = 13$) has the same binding estimate but only 135/123 bits for hiding (dual hybrid, $\beta = 463$); this is why the production set raises the M-LWE rank to $\lambda = 7$.

E. Envelopes, registry and sessions

The envelope is

$$E_{\mathrm{in}} = \texttt{"ZKLB"} \,\|\, \texttt{0x01} \,\|\, pid \,\|\, N_s \,\|\, t \,\|\, \pi,$$
$$E_{\mathrm{reg}} = \texttt{"ZKLR"} \,\|\, \texttt{0x01} \,\|\, pid \,\|\, N_s \,\|\, \pi,$$

for the in-band and registered modes. In the in-band mode a fresh commitment t (6 720 bytes) to the payload travels in the video; the payload is encoded injectively into N coefficients and is at most 766 bytes. In the registered mode t is the holder's credential commitment, whose bytes enter the verification-key hash that the issuer signs into the registry, so only the credential holder can produce an accepting proof and the video carries only π.

The verifier resolves its pins from the registry: it checks the ML-DSA-65 signature against the pinned issuer key, rejects epochs below its floor, rejects parameter sets with a challenge space below 2^{256}, and requires exactly one record matching its parameter set, carrier profile and (in registered mode) credential. Session challenges are 32-byte random

Algorithm 2 Video-level embedding and verification.

Embed(cover, payload or credential, pins, N_s, key)
$E_0 \leftarrow$ placeholder envelope of the final length; chunk it
$(P, D) \leftarrow$ carrier layout and normalized digest of cover for E_0
$x \leftarrow \mathrm{Statement}(\text{pins}, N_s, |P|, \mathsf{H}(P), V(D))$
$E \leftarrow$ envelope with $\pi \leftarrow$ **Prove**(pid, x, t, r)
abort unless $\mathrm{chunks}(E)$ has the layout of $\mathrm{chunks}(E_0)$
write $\mathrm{chunks}(E)$ into the carriers P by patching; **return** stego

VerifyVideo(stego, pins, session store, key)
$(P', D', E) \leftarrow$ blind extraction (same rule and key); reject on CRC or framing error
$x' \leftarrow \mathrm{Statement}(\text{pins}, N_s(E), |P'|, \mathsf{H}(P'), V(D'))$
return $\mathrm{ConsumeIf}(N_s(E),$ **Verify**$(pid, x', t, \pi))$

values stored in a SQLite database with a time-to-live and a binding digest over the parameter set, relation, registry root and epoch, codec policy and carrier profile. The verifier reads N_s from the extracted envelope only to look it up; in a single transaction it checks that the challenge was issued, is unexpired, unconsumed and correctly bound, verifies the proof under the statement it built, and marks the challenge consumed only if verification succeeds.

F. Linkage and disclosure

A holder of two openings can prove that two commitments hide the same payload with the equality proof (16 160 bytes), bound to the two commitments and to a context such as the two statement identifiers. This links two in-band videos to one payload, or links an in-band video to a registered credential after the fact, without revealing the payload. A holder can also disclose the payload to a chosen party without revealing the randomness: the disclosure is the payload with an equality proof between the extracted commitment and the deterministic commitment to the payload under zero randomness, bound to the recipient's statement identifier and nonce (16 160 bytes of proof). The recipient learns the payload but cannot reuse the commitment in new proofs.

G. Carrier ordering key

With a secret stego key shared by holder and verifier, the carrier layout is unknown to third parties, which is what steganographic undetectability requires: without a secret, anyone who knows the scheme can locate the carriers and test for an envelope [51]. Where undetectability is not required, the ordering key can be derived from public registered configuration, $\mathrm{SHA\text{-}256}(\mathit{domain} \,\|\, \mathit{pid} \,\|\, \mathit{profile})$, so that anyone with the registry can verify. The key only determines where bits are found: soundness and zero knowledge of the proof do not depend on it, because the verifier recomputes P and V and both enter the statement.

VI. Security model and analysis

This section states what the system proves and under which assumptions. All results are in the classical random-oracle model (ROM). No theorem in the quantum random-oracle model (QROM) is claimed (Section VI-K). Full proofs are in Appendix A; the cross-check of every definition against the implementation is in Appendix B.

TABLE II
Concrete quantities for `BDLOP-OPEN-128-V2`

Quantity	Value
$\lvert\mathcal{C}\rvert$	$2^{257.01}$
Fiat–Shamir seed length	256 bits
$p_{\mathrm{acc}} = ((2B+1)/2\gamma)^{kN}$ (opening)	0.1912
p_{acc}^2 (equality proof)	0.0365
Attempt cap $A_{\max}$ (opening; equality)	512; 4 096
$(1-p_{\mathrm{acc}})^{512}$; $(1-p_{\mathrm{acc}}^2)^{4096}$	$2^{-156.7}$; $2^{-220.0}$
$\eta = nN\log_2(2B+1)$ (min-entropy of w)	27 646.98 bits
$\beta = 8\kappa B$ (M-SIS bound)	$62\,885\,280 \approx 2^{25.91}$
$2\kappa + 2B$ (one honest, one relaxed opening)	$262\,142 \approx 2^{18.0}$
$\sqrt{q/2}$ (invertibility threshold)	23 170.5
$3^{kN} q^{-(n+1)N}$	$\approx 2^{-48\,079}$
Statement x	274 bytes
Envelope, in-band / registered	14 885 / 8 165 bytes

A. Notation, parameters and assumptions

Let $\mathcal{R} = \mathbb{Z}[X]/(X^N+1)$ and $\mathcal{R}_q = \mathcal{R}/q\mathcal{R}$, with $N = 256$ and the prime $q = 2^{30} - 35 \equiv 5 \pmod 8$. The commitment key is $\mathsf{ck} = (B_1, b_2)$ with $B_1 = [I_n \,|\, B_1'] \in \mathcal{R}_q^{n\times k}$, $b_2 = [0^n \,|\, 1 \,|\, b_2'] \in \mathcal{R}_q^{1\times k}$, $k = n+\lambda+1$, $n = 6$, $\lambda = 7$ (so $k = 14$). S_1 is the set of polynomials with coefficients in $\{-1, 0, 1\}$. For a message $m \in \mathcal{R}_q$ and $r \in S_1^k$, $\mathsf{Com}(m; r) = (t_1, t_2) = (B_1 r,\ \langle b_2, r\rangle + m)$. The challenge set is $\mathcal{C} = \{c \in \mathcal{R} : \|c\|_\infty = 1,\ \|c\|_1 = \kappa\}$ with $\kappa = 60$, so $|\mathcal{C}| = \binom{256}{60} 2^{60} = 2^{257.01}$; its difference set is $\bar{\mathcal{C}} = \{c - c' : c \neq c' \in \mathcal{C}\}$. Masks are uniform on $Y = [-\gamma+1, \gamma]^{kN}$ with $\gamma = 2^{17}$; responses are accepted iff they lie in $Z = [-B, B]^{kN}$, $B = \gamma - \kappa - 1$. We use $\|fv\|_\infty \le \|f\|_1 \|v\|_\infty$ throughout. The concrete quantities used in the bounds are collected in Table II.

Lemma 1 (Invertible challenge differences)**.** *Every $f \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$ is invertible in $\mathcal{R}_q$.*

Proof. Since $q \equiv 5 \pmod 8$, $X^N + 1$ splits modulo q into exactly two irreducible factors, and every nonzero $y \in \mathcal{R}_q$ with $\|y\|_\infty < q^{1/2}/\sqrt{2}$ is invertible (Lyubashevsky–Seiler [41], Corollary 1.2 with $k = 2$). Any $f \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$ is nonzero with $\|f\|_\infty \le 2 < 23\,170$. The constructor of the parameter set enforces both conditions (`params.py:49-51`, `ring.py:52-58`). □

Definition 1 (Openings)**.** *A* relaxed opening *of $t = (t_1, t_2)$ is a pair $(\bar r, f)$ with $f \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$, $\|\bar r\|_\infty \le 2B$ and $f t_1 = B_1 \bar r$. It defines the message $\bar m = t_2 - f^{-1}\langle b_2, \bar r\rangle$, the unique $\bar m$ with $f t_2 = \langle b_2, \bar r\rangle + f\bar m$ (Lemma 1). An* honest opening *is $(r, 1)$ with $r \in S_1^k$ and $t_1 = B_1 r$, with message $t_2 - \langle b_2, r\rangle$; it is what a disclosure reveals.*

a) Assumptions: $\mathsf{Adv}^{\text{M-SIS}}$ is the advantage of finding $x \in \mathcal{R}^k$ with $B_1 x \equiv 0 \pmod q$, $0 < \|x\|_\infty \le \beta = 8\kappa B$, for uniform B_1'. $\mathsf{Adv}^{\text{M-LWE}}$ is the advantage of distinguishing $(A, As + e)$ from uniform for uniform $A \in \mathcal{R}_q^{(n+1)\times\lambda}$ and $s \in S_1^\lambda$, $e \in S_1^{n+1}$. These are the two instances estimated at 140/127 and 164/150 bits (classical/ quantum core-SVP, Table I); the quantum M-SIS estimate is just below 128 bits. Every M-SIS solution in this section has norm at most β, so no further lattice assumption is needed. $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}}$ and $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA3}}$ are collision-finding advantages against SHA-256 and SHA3-256,

and $\mathsf{Adv}^{\text{euf-cma}}_{\text{ML-DSA}}$ is the EUF-CMA advantage against ML-DSA-65 [12].

b) Random oracles: We model as independent random oracles the SHAKE-256 instances used for the Fiat–Shamir challenge seed H_{fs} (and H_{eq} for the equality proof), the challenge expansion $G : \{0,1\}^{256} \to \mathcal{C}$ (SampleInBall), the mask stream, the key expansion, and the SHA3-256 hedging hash. Their domain tags are pairwise prefix-free (Appendix B), so one SHAKE-256 oracle splits into independent oracles. G is exactly uniform on $\mathcal{C}$ on a fresh input: the signs and the Fisher–Yates indices are drawn by exact rejection sampling. The key expansion as a random oracle makes ck uniform; it is a single global key derived from a public seed (no per-user key). Q_H denotes the total number of random-oracle queries of the adversary, including those made on its behalf by verification queries, plus one.

B. Syntax of the composed scheme

The transport layer is a set of deterministic functions of a pinned carrier profile prof and a synchronization key k_s: $\mathsf{Place}(\mathsf{vid}, \ell)$ returns the ordered carrier positions P for an ℓ-byte envelope; $\mathsf{Canon}(\mathsf{vid}, P)$ returns the carrier-normalized digest D; $\mathsf{Write}(\mathsf{vid}, P, E)$ writes envelope E into the carriers; $\mathsf{Read}(\mathsf{vid})$ returns (E, P, D) or $\perp$. *Transport correctness* means $\mathsf{Read}(\mathsf{Write}(\mathsf{vid}, P, E)) = (E, P, \mathsf{Canon}(\mathsf{vid}, P))$ for $P = \mathsf{Place}(\mathsf{vid}, |E|)$; it is a functional property, and its failure only causes rejection.

- Setup: fixes the parameter set, pid (a SHA3-256 digest of all parameters and the setup seed) and ck.
- RegKeyGen, RegSign: the issuer holds an ML-DSA-65 key pair (pk_I, sk_I) and signs a registry $\mathsf{Reg} = (e, \Delta)$: an epoch and a set of relation descriptors. A descriptor hashes pid, the key, the relation module and the policy (codec policy and carrier profile); in registered mode it also hashes a credential commitment t_c.
- Pins: given Reg, pk_I, prof, a rollback floor $e_{\min}$ and (registered mode) t_c, verifies the signature, recomputes the expected descriptor, requires exactly one match, and outputs $\mathsf{pins} = (rid, root, e, cpid, prof_id)$, or fails.
- Issue: draws a uniform 32-byte challenge N_s and stores it with the binding $\mathsf{bind}(\mathsf{pins})$ and an expiry.
- Embed: on cover vid, payload p (in-band) or credential (t_c, r_c) (registered), pins and N_s: compute $P = \mathsf{Place}(\mathsf{vid}, \ell)$ from a zero placeholder of the final length ℓ, $D = \mathsf{Canon}(\mathsf{vid}, P)$ and $x = \mathsf{Stmt}(\mathsf{pins}, N_s, P, D)$; in-band, sample $r \leftarrow S_1^k$, set $t = \mathsf{Com}(\mathsf{enc}(p); r)$; prove $\pi \leftarrow \mathsf{P}(x, t, r)$; form $E = \texttt{"ZKLB"} \| 1 \| pid \| N_s \| t \| \pi$ (or $\texttt{"ZKLR"} \| 1 \| pid \| N_s \| \pi$) and output $\mathsf{Write}(\mathsf{vid}, P, E)$ and, in-band, the opening (p, r).
- Verify: on vid^*: $(E^*, P^*, D^*) = \mathsf{Read}(\mathsf{vid}^*)$; parse E^* strictly; take N_s^* from E^* (store mode) or use a fixed N_s (stateless mode); $x^* = \mathsf{Stmt}(\mathsf{pins}, N_s^*, P^*, D^*)$; accept iff $\mathsf{V}(x^*, t^*, \pi^*) = 1$ with t^* from E^* (in-band) or the pinned t_c (registered) and, in store mode, N_s^* is live for $\mathsf{bind}(\mathsf{pins})$ and is atomically consumed.
- VerDisc: accepts (E, p, r) iff $(r, 1)$ is an honest opening of the commitment in E to $\mathsf{enc}(p)$.
- Link, VerLink: the equality proof Π_{eq} on two commitments, bound to a context digest $lx = \mathrm{SHA3}(\mathrm{tag} \| pid \| \text{length-prefixed context})$.

The statement is the 274-byte string

$$\mathsf{Stmt} = \mathtt{u16}(1) \| rid \| pid \| root \| \mathtt{u64}(e) \| N_s \| cpid \| prof_id \\ \| \mathtt{u64}(|P|) \| \mathrm{SHA256}(P) \| V, \quad V = \mathrm{SHA256}(\mathrm{tag} \| D),$$

with $\mathrm{SHA256}(P)$ taken over a canonical JSON encoding of the ordered positions. The opening proof Π_{open} outputs $\pi = (h, z)$ with $h = H_{\mathsf{fs}}(\mathrm{tag} \| pid \| \mathtt{u64}(|x|) \| x \| \mathsf{enc}(t) \| \mathsf{enc}(w))$, $w = B_1 y$, $c = G(h)$, $z = y + cr \in Z$; the verifier recomputes $w' = B_1 z - c t_1$ and checks h. Every field after x has a length fixed by pid, so the hash input is uniquely decodable.

C. Adversary model

The adversary $\mathcal{A}$ is a classical probabilistic algorithm. It controls every channel, chooses covers and payloads, knows k_s (no property below depends on its secrecy), and has the following oracles. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Iss}}$ returns a fresh N_s. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Emb}}(\mathsf{vid}, p, N_s)$ runs an honest in-band Embed and returns the stego video; $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{EmbR}}(j, \mathsf{vid}, N_s)$ does the same for honest holder j's registered credential. We let these oracles prove arbitrary statements x chosen by $\mathcal{A}$, which only strengthens the results. Their outputs form the list L of triples (x, t, π). $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Ver}}$ runs Verify with the shared store. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Link}}$ returns honest linkage proofs between recorded commitments. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Disc}}(i)$ returns the opening of the i-th honest commitment and marks it *disclosed*. $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Reg}}(e, \Delta, T)$ has the issuer sign a registry with epoch e whose descriptors are the in-band descriptors Δ and the registered descriptors that the issuer computes from the credential commitments in T, all of $\mathcal{A}$'s choice; T_{reg} is the union of all queried T. (An issuer signs a registered descriptor only for a credential it has vetted, so registered descriptors enter only through T.) Q_P bounds the number of proofs produced by honest parties.

The issuer and verifier are honest; the session store is linearizable and durable. Holder corruption is static (the adversary registers its own credentials through $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Reg}}$); disclosure is the only form of adaptive corruption, and disclosed commitments are excluded from winning conditions. Side channels, codec bugs, and the transport's correctness are out of scope.

D. Zero knowledge of the Fiat–Shamir-with-aborts proof

Lemma 2 (Witness-independent acceptance)**.** *For every $r \in S_1^k$ and $c \in \mathcal{C}$, an attempt with $y \leftarrow Y$ is accepted with probability exactly p_{acc}, and conditioned on acceptance $z = y + cr$ is uniform on Z.*

Each coefficient v of cr satisfies $|v| \le \kappa$, so the $2B+1$ values $z_i \in [-B, B]$ correspond to masks $z_i - v \in [-\gamma+1, \gamma-1] \subset [-\gamma+1, \gamma]$, each of probability $1/2\gamma$.

Lemma 3 (Simulation)**.** *There is a simulator that, given only (x, t) and programming access to H_{fs}, outputs proofs whose joint distribution with the random oracles is within*

$$\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P, Q_H) = 2Q_P(Q_H + Q_P)2^{-256} \\ + (A_{\max}+1)Q_P\big(Q_H + (A_{\max}+1)Q_P\big)2^{-\eta}$$

of Q_P real proofs, for any adversary making Q_H queries. The same holds for Π_{eq} with p_{acc}^2 in place of p_{acc}.

The simulator samples the attempt count from the truncated geometric distribution with parameter p_{acc}, outputs $\perp$ with probability $(1-p_{\mathrm{acc}})^{A_{\max}}$, and otherwise samples $h \leftarrow \{0,1\}^{256}$, $z \leftarrow Z$, sets $w = B_1 z - G(h)t_1$ and programs H_{fs} at (pid, x, t, w). The delicate step is the random-oracle queries that the real prover makes in rejected attempts and never reveals: the earlier analyses of Fiat–Shamir with aborts mishandled the corresponding reprogramming in the CMA-to-NMA step, as identified and repaired by Barbosa et al. [44] and analysed in detail by Devevey et al. [45]. Here the step is discharged in the classical ROM by two facts specific to this instantiation: acceptance is *exactly* independent of the witness and of c (Lemma 2), and every hidden query point contains $w = B_1 y$ of min-entropy at least η (because $B_1 = [I_n | B_1']$). Exact independence also means the attempt count leaks nothing, although the implementation is not constant time otherwise.

E. Knowledge soundness and binding to the video

Definition 2 (Simulation-extractable video binding)**.** *In experiment* SE*, $\mathcal{A}$ interacts with all oracles and outputs* vid^**. Let x^* be the statement the verifier recomputes from* vid^* *and its own pins, and (t^*, π^*) the commitment and proof it verifies. $\mathcal{A}$* wins *if* Verify *accepts and $(x^*, t^*, \pi^*) \notin L$. An extractor $\mathcal{E}^{\mathcal{A}}$* succeeds *if it outputs x^* and a relaxed opening of t^*, where x^* is the verifier's statement in a winning run of $\mathcal{A}$.*

Theorem 1 (Knowledge soundness bound to the statement)**.** *Let $\mathcal{A}$ win* SE *with probability ε. There is an extractor $\mathcal{E}$ that runs $\mathcal{A}$ twice with simulated oracles and succeeds with probability $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}}$ such that*

$$\varepsilon \le \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P, Q_H) + \mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}} + Q_H 2^{-256} + \sqrt{Q_H\big(\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} + Q_H 2^{-256} + 2^{-257}\big)}.$$

Proof idea. Replace honest proofs by simulated ones (Lemma 3). If $\mathcal{A}$ re-uses a programmed point, i.e. $(x^*, t^*) = (x_i, t_i)$ and $w^* = w_i$, then $h^* = h_i$, hence $c^* = c_i$ and $B_1(z^* - z_i) = 0$ with $0 < \|z^* - z_i\|_\infty \le 2B$: an M-SIS solution. Otherwise the verifier's query (pid, x^*, t^*, w^*) is answered by a fresh random value, and the general forking lemma of Bellare and Neven [52] (Lemma 1) with output space 2^{256} yields two accepting proofs with the same (x^*, t^*, w^*) and seeds $h \neq h'$. Then $c = G(h) \neq G(h') = c'$ except with probability $2^{-257} + Q_H 2^{-256}$, and $B_1(z - z') = (c - c')t_1^*$ gives the relaxed opening $(z - z', c - c')$. The challenge difference is invertible by Lemma 1, which is what makes the opening define a unique message. Because the forked query contains x^*, the opening is bound to exactly the verifier-recomputed statement: its video commitment, carrier positions, session challenge, registry root and epoch, relation and policy. □

The square-root loss is the usual price of rewinding. For $Q_H = 2^{64}$ the bound converts an extraction probability of 2^{-128} into $\varepsilon \lesssim 2^{-32}$. For authenticity (Theorem 5) a tight bound is available by the SelfTargetMSIS route of Kiltz, Lyubashevsky and Schaffner [53], at the cost of that non-standard assumption.

Theorem 2 (Binding with respect to relaxed openings)**.** *No adversary can output t and two openings of t, each honest or relaxed, with different messages, except with probability* $\mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}}$.

Given $(\bar r, f, m)$ and $(\bar r', f', m')$, the vector $x = f'\bar r - f\bar r'$ satisfies $B_1 x = 0$; if $x = 0$ then $\langle b_2, x\rangle = ff'(m - m') = 0$, contradicting invertibility. Its norm is at most $2{\cdot}2\kappa{\cdot}2B = \beta$ for two relaxed openings, $2\kappa + 2B$ for one honest and one relaxed, and 2 for two honest ones, all below $q/2$ (`params.py:53`), so $x \not\equiv 0$ is an M-SIS solution.

Together, Theorems 1 and 2 say: whoever produces an accepted in-band video is bound to the message $\bar m$ the extractor computes, and any later disclosure that $\mathsf{VerDisc}$ accepts reveals a payload p with $\mathsf{enc}(p) = \bar m$, unless M-SIS is broken.

Disclosure keeps the randomness private. A disclosure is the payload p together with an equality proof between t and the deterministic commitment $\mathsf{Com}(\mathsf{enc}(p); 0)$, bound by Fiat–Shamir to a recipient-chosen context (statement identifier and nonce). The recipient learns p but no opening of t, so it cannot produce new opening proofs for t; by soundness of the equality proof, an accepted disclosure still satisfies $\mathsf{enc}(p) = \bar m$ unless M-SIS is broken. An earlier version revealed r itself; this was item D3 in Appendix B and is fixed. The theorems below still treat commitments whose *opening* has leaked (e.g. by key compromise) as disclosed.

Lemma 4 (One-wayness of honest commitments)**.** *Given* ck *and $t^{(j)} = \mathsf{Com}(m_j; r_j)$, $j \le Q$, for $r_j \leftarrow S_1^k$ and messages m_j chosen adaptively before each $t^{(j)}$ is drawn, no adversary outputs a relaxed opening of any $t^{(j)}$ except with probability $\mathsf{Adv}_Q^{\mathsf{row}} = \mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}} + Q\big(\mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-LWE}} + 3^{kN} q^{-(n+1)N}\big)$.*

Put $x = f r_j - \bar r$, so $B_1 x = 0$ and $\|x\|_\infty \le 2\kappa + 2B$. If $x \neq 0$ it is an M-SIS solution (the reduction generated every $t^{(j)}$ and knows r_j). If $x = 0$ the adversary has found $r_j = f^{-1}\bar r$, which a distinguisher that planted its M-LWE sample at a guessed j checks against $t^{(j)}$; for uniform $t^{(j)}$ a ternary opening exists with probability at most $3^{kN} q^{-(n+1)N}$. Binding alone does not suffice here: an adversary that recovers r_j opens $t^{(j)}$ to the right message.

F. Payload hiding

Definition 3 (Payload indistinguishability)**.** *In* IND^b*, $\mathcal{A}$ has all oracles and submits once* $(\mathsf{vid}, p_0, p_1, N_s)$ *with $|p_0|, |p_1| \le$ 766 bytes; the challenger returns $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Emb}}(\mathsf{vid}, p_b, N_s)$. $\mathcal{A}$ may not query $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Disc}}$ or $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Link}}$ on the challenge commitment.* $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{ind}} = |\Pr[\mathsf{IND}^1 = 1] - \Pr[\mathsf{IND}^0 = 1]|$.

Theorem 3 (Hiding)**.** $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{ind}} \le 2\,\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P + 1, Q_H) + 2\mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-LWE}}$.

The stego video depends on b only through E: P and D are fixed from a placeholder before proving, and the envelope has a fixed size, so the payload length is hidden too. Simulate the challenge proof (Lemma 3), then replace t by a uniform pair: with $B_1' = [B_{1,2}' \,|\, B_{1,3}']$ and $r = (r_1, r_2, r_3)$, $(t_1 - B_{1,2}'(t_2 -$

$m)$, $t_2 - m) = Ar_3 + (r_1, r_2)$ with $A = \begin{bmatrix} B'_{1,3} - B'_{1,2} b'_2 \\ b'_2 \end{bmatrix}$ uniform, an M-LWE sample of rank λ with $n+1$ ring samples; the map is a bijection for each fixed m. The experiment is then independent of b. Hiding is computational and is the only property that rests on M-LWE; it holds for the payload, not for the fact that a payload exists, which is a steganographic property evaluated empirically.

G. Replay resistance

Definition 4 (Replay)**.** *In* RPL*, $\mathcal{A}$ has all oracles against a verifier with a session store and wins if (i) two calls of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Ver}}$ accept with the same N_s; or (ii) a call accepts with an N_s that was not issued for* bind(pins)*, or is expired; or (iii) a call accepts* vid^* *whose triple $(x^*, t^*, \pi^*) \notin L$ and $\mathcal{A}$ queried H_{fs} at the verifier's point (pid, x^*, t^*, w^*) before N_s^* was issued.*

Theorem 4 (Replay resistance)**.** $\Pr[\textit{(i) or (ii)}] \le \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}} + Q_I^2 2^{-257}$ *and* $\Pr[\textit{(iii)}] \le Q_H Q_I 2^{-256}$*, with Q_I issued sessions.*

(i) and (ii) follow from the store semantics: rows exist only for issued challenges (keyed by a SHA-256 digest of N_s), and consumption is a single conditional `UPDATE ... WHERE consumed_at IS NULL AND expires_at>now` inside one write transaction, so at most one caller observes one updated row (`zkp_sessions.py:181–241`). For (iii), N_s^* is a substring of x^*, so a query made earlier predicts a uniform 256-bit value. Together with Theorem 1, an accepted session corresponds to a party that knew an opening and computed the proof after the session was issued.

What a stateless verifier cannot give. With a fixed N_s (`expected_session`), (i) fails: any copy of an accepted video is accepted again, by anyone and any number of times, since a non-interactive proof is transferable. If N_s is reused across verifications, (iii) fails as well and only video binding (Theorem 1) remains. No variant prevents relaying: in-band mode does not bind N_s to a prover, so whoever first presents a valid video consumes the session.

H. Registered-mode authenticity

Definition 5 (Authenticity)**.** *In* AUTH*, the challenger creates honest credentials $t_c^{(j)} = \mathsf{Com}(m_j; r_j)$, $j \le Q_C$, with m_j chosen by $\mathcal{A}$, and $\mathcal{A}$ has all oracles. $\mathcal{A}$ outputs* $(\mathsf{Reg}^*, \mathsf{vid}^*, t^*)$ *and wins if a verifier pinning pk_I and t^* accepts* vid^* *with pins from* Reg^**, the triple $(x^*, t^*, \pi^*) \notin L$, and either (a) $t^* \notin T_{\mathsf{reg}}$ (never registered by the issuer), or (b) $t^* = t_c^{(j)}$ for an undisclosed honest j.*

Theorem 5 (Authenticity)**.**

$$\begin{aligned}\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{auth}} \le\ & \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{euf\text{-}cma}}_{\mathsf{ML\text{-}DSA}} + \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}} + \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P, Q_H) \\ & + \mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}} + Q_H 2^{-256} \\ & + \sqrt{Q_H\big(\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{row}}_{Q_C} + Q_H 2^{-256} + 2^{-257}\big)}.\end{aligned}$$

Case (a) gives an ML-DSA forgery on the registry signing bytes or, if Reg^* was signed, a SHA-256 collision between the fixed-length inputs $B'_1 \| b'_2 \| t^*$ and $B'_1 \| b'_2 \| t'$ for some $t' \in T_{\mathsf{reg}}$, since the matching descriptor contains that digest. In case (b), Theorem 1 applied to the simulated game extracts a relaxed opening of an honest credential, which Lemma 4 rules out. The theorem is about credentials; the link to a person is only as strong as the issuer's check of the holder before signing. When the issuer binds a holder identifier, the signed descriptor contains a domain-separated digest of it next to the commitment, so the verifier's pinned relation names both (Appendix B, item D2, fixed).

I. Linkage

Definition 6 (Linkage soundness and hiding)**.** *In* LNK-S*, $\mathcal{A}$ outputs a context, t_a, t_b, an accepted π_{eq} not output by $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Link}}$ for that triple, and openings (honest or relaxed) of t_a and t_b with different messages. In* LNK-H^b*, $\mathcal{A}$ submits (p_0, p_1, ctx) and receives $t_a = \mathsf{Com}(p_b; r_a)$, $t_b = \mathsf{Com}(p_b; r_b)$ and π_{eq} for ctx.*

Theorem 6 (Linkage)**.** $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{lnk\text{-}s}}$ *obeys the bound of Theorem 1 with $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} \le \mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}}$, and* $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{lnk\text{-}h}} \le 2\,\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P + 1, Q_H) + 4\mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-LWE}}$.

Two forked transcripts with one announcement (w_a, w_b, u) give relaxed openings $(\bar{r}_a, f)$, $(\bar{r}_b, f)$ with a *common* f and $f(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b}) = \langle b_2, \bar{r}_a - \bar{r}_b \rangle$, hence $\bar{m}_a = \bar{m}_b$; the adversary's two openings then contradict Theorem 2 for t_a or for t_b. Linkage to a registered credential additionally authenticates its holder, as in Theorem 5, because extraction also yields a relaxed opening of t_c. Hiding uses the simulator for Π_{eq} and two M-LWE hybrids; equality of the two payloads is revealed by design.

J. Integrity of the video content

Canon splits the stream with the pinned segmenter (`ffmpeg -c:v copy -f segment`, F frames per segment) and combines per-segment digests with F and the frame counts. A segment that carries envelope chunks is hashed through a length-delimited, tagged serialization: for every NAL unit its index, type, `forbidden_zero_bit`, `nal_ref_idc` and start-code size; the RBSP verbatim for NAL units without carriers; and, inside an IDR NAL unit with carriers, the RBSP bits between carrier blocks up to the stop bit, with each carrier block replaced by its coefficient vector in which every carrier is normalized (magnitude rounded down to even, sign kept). Other segments are hashed byte for byte.

Lemma 5 (What the digest and the envelope determine)**.** *The serialization is uniquely decodable, so equal V implies equal* Canon *except with probability* $3\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}}$*. Under the stable carrier rule ($|\ell| \ge 4$, one parity bit) a carrier level is $\mathrm{sgn}(\ell)(2\lfloor |\ell|/2 \rfloor + b)$, so (Canon, P) and the carrier bits determine the complete coefficient vector of every carrier block. If the carrier bit string is the unique encoding of E under the pinned profile, (Canon, P, E) determines: the segmentation and frame counts; every byte of segments without carriers; every NAL header field and RBSP bit outside carrier blocks; and the coefficient vectors of carrier blocks.*

Theorem 7 (Integrity)**.** *Suppose an honest embedding produced* vid_h *for session N_s with commitment t (or credential t_c), and $\mathcal{A}$ outputs* vid^* *that is accepted for N_s with*

the same commitment (or credential), not disclosed. Then $\mathsf{Canon}(\mathsf{vid}^*) = \mathsf{Canon}(\mathsf{vid}_h)$*,* $P^* = P_h$ *and* $E^* = E_h$*, except with probability at most*

$$4\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}} + \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P, Q_H) + \mathsf{Adv}^{\textit{M-SIS}} + Q_H 2^{-256} + \sqrt{Q_H\big(\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{row}}_{Q_P} + Q_H 2^{-256} + 2^{-257}\big)}.$$

If $x^* \neq x_h$, the triple is fresh and extraction yields a relaxed opening of an honest commitment. If $x^* = x_h$, the positions hash and V agree, and Lemma 5 applies; the proof is then the honest one, otherwise the programmed-point case of Theorem 1 gives an M-SIS solution.

a) Limits of the integrity claim:

- In-band mode binds content to a *commitment*, not to a person: anyone holding a live N_s can re-embed any edited video with a fresh commitment of its own, and it will be accepted.
- Carriers are protected only as envelope bits. Theorem 7 needs the carrier bits to be the unique encoding of E. The verifier re-chunks E under the pinned chunk size and rejects unless the extracted pieces are exactly that encoding; without this check a single-chunk envelope left its 16-bit `chunk_size` field free (item D1 in Appendix B, fixed).
- Not bound: bytes that do not survive the pinned segmenter (container data, other streams, data outside NAL units); RBSP alignment bits after the stop bit in carrier-bearing IDR NAL units; alternative CAVLC codewords for the same coefficient vector of a carrier block; the emulation-prevention layer (the digest covers the RBSP); and the segmenter version, which the codec policy names but does not pin.
- No codec-correctness claim: the digest covers syntax, not decoded pixels. No provenance claim: nothing says a camera recorded vid_h or that the payload is true.

K. Quantum adversaries

All theorems above are classical-ROM statements. Rewinding (Theorem 1) and adaptive programming (Lemma 3) do not carry over to the QROM as stated. Barbosa et al. [44] give QROM proofs of the CMA-to-NMA step for Fiat–Shamir with aborts, and Don et al. [46] and Liu and Zhandry [47] show that the Fiat–Shamir transform preserves (knowledge) soundness of suitable Σ-protocols against quantum adversaries with polynomial loss. We have not verified that their hypotheses hold for the relaxed extractor and the aborting prover used here, so we claim no QROM theorem. Our wording is "plausibly post-quantum": the reductions target M-SIS, M-LWE, ML-DSA and hash collisions, none of which has a known efficient quantum attack at these parameters.

VII. Implementation

The backend is a self-contained, pure-Python implementation (Python 3.12, NumPy) of about 1 700 lines for the ring, sampling, commitment, opening and equality proofs, payload codec, statement, envelope, linkage and a command-line interface that separates the issuer, holder and verifier roles. Polynomial multiplication uses exact big-integer Kronecker substitution; there is no NTT because $q \equiv 5 \pmod 8$ does not split $X^N + 1$ fully. The H.264 side reuses a Python CAVLC parser and bitstream patcher with a blind carrier synchronizer, a carrier canonicalizer, the chunk framing, an ML-DSA-65-signed relation registry (via the `pqcrypto` bindings) and the SQLite session store. The test suite covers the ring and samplers, commitment and proof correctness, the accepted-response uniformity and the acceptance edge, extraction of relaxed openings from two transcripts, statement substitution, envelope tampering, registry pinning and rollback, session replay, linkage, the CLI, and byte-exact known-answer vectors for the parameter set.

a) Sizes: Commitment 6 720 B, opening proof 8 096 B (a 32-byte challenge seed and kN responses of 18 bits), equality proof 16 160 B, envelope header 69 B; hence 8 165 B (registered) and 14 885 B (in-band) in the video, plus 23 B of framing per chunk.

b) Timing: On the evaluation host (single thread, idle), the median times over 50 runs are 21 ms to commit, 120 ms to prove (95th percentile 302 ms) and 22 ms to verify an opening, and 0.97 s and 46 ms for the equality proof (measured with `bdlop-open-128-v1`)**[TODO: v2 measurement]**. Cryptography is therefore negligible end to end: embedding and verification of a clip take minutes and are dominated by the Python CAVLC analysis and patching (Table IV). A faster verification path is in progress; **[TODO: update verification times after the verification speed-up (roadmap A2)]**.

c) Why not a native encoder path: Embedding inside an encoder would change the reconstructed reference pixels, and with them all subsequent intra-predicted values, as a function of the proof bits, so a statement could not bind the video without a codec-level relation. Post-encoding patching with a carrier-normalized digest keeps the statement independent of the proof.

VIII. Evaluation

A. Setup

All measurements were taken on one Windows 11 host with an Intel Core i7-12700H (14 cores) and 24 GB of RAM. Sources are standard Xiph test sequences: CIF (352×288; 300 frames, except Deadline with 1 374 and Football with 260) and 4CIF (704×576; 600 frames). They were encoded with FFmpeg/libx264 in the Baseline profile (CAVLC), all-intra ($GOP = 1$, no B-frames) at a fixed QP of 18, 22 or 28. Two longer inputs were used for the earliest runs: the first 1 000 frames of Deadline, and Coastguard looped ten times to 3 000 frames (marked $*$). Quality is the FFmpeg luma PSNR of the decoded stego against the decoded cover; the PSNR of modified frames is computed from their mean MSE, and SSIM is over the whole video. Unless stated otherwise the registered mode and the magnitude carrier are used, with 100-frame segments and a chunk size chosen from the measured capacity of each clip. Experiments ran sequentially, except where noted in the tables.

TABLE III
STABLE, PATCHABILITY-CHECKED MAGNITUDE CARRIERS (ALL-INTRA, X264 BASELINE/CAVLC). SEG. SCANNED: 100-FRAME SEGMENTS MEASURED OUT OF THE CLIP'S TOTAL; UNSCANNED SEGMENTS ARE EXTRAPOLATED FROM THE SCANNED ONES. FRAMES NEEDED: SEGMENTS REQUIRED AT THE SMALLEST FEASIBLE CHUNK SIZE; † MORE THAN THE CLIP HAS.

Clip	Res.	QP	Frames	Seg.	kbit/100 fr.		Frames needed	
				scanned	min	mean	reg.	in-band
Akiyo	CIF	22	300	1/3	10.5	10.5	600†	1200†
Foreman	CIF	22	300	1/3	14.1	14.1	500†	900†
Football	CIF	22	260	3/3	14.3	21.6	500†	900†
City	CIF	22	300	3/3	21.7	23.8	300	600†
Hall	CIF	22	300	3/3	27.1	27.6	300	500†
Coastguard	CIF	22	300	3/3	31.4	36.3	200	400†
Deadline	CIF	22	1374	1/14	46.6	46.6	200	300
Container	CIF	22	300	3/3	47.9	49.8	200	300
Container	CIF	28	300	3/3	9.1	10.0	700†	1300†
Container	CIF	18	300	3/3	86.3	88.3	100	200
Crew	4CIF	22	600	3/6	11.1	13.2	600	1100†
Soccer	4CIF	22	600	3/6	3.5	30.0	1900†	3600†
Harbour	4CIF	22	600	4/6	48.8	50.0	200	300
City	4CIF	22	600	3/6	68.1	82.3	100	200
City	4CIF	28	600	3/6	4.4	5.4	1500†	2800†
Crew	4CIF	18	600	6/6	19.6	34.7	400	600
City	4CIF	18	600	3/6	208.8	248.1	100	100

B. Capacity

Table III lists stable, patchability-checked carriers. At QP 22 CIF clips offer 10.5–49.8 kbit per 100 frames. Textured content (Container, Deadline, Coastguard) carries the registered envelope (about 65.3 kbit) in 200 frames, and Container and Deadline carry the in-band envelope (about 119.1 kbit) in 300; flat or smooth content (Akiyo, Foreman) cannot carry the registered envelope in its 300 frames.**[TODO: v2 measurement]** Capacity falls steeply with QP (Container: 88.3, 49.8 and 10.0 kbit at QP 18, 22 and 28), because coarser quantization leaves fewer coefficients with $|level| \geq 4$, and grows with resolution where the content is textured (City: 23.8 kbit at CIF, 82.3 kbit at 4CIF). Capacity also varies strongly within a clip: one Soccer segment offers only 3.5 kbit, and Crew offers 11–17 kbit per segment, so the sweep skipped both 4CIF clips as not fitting. The capacity scan exposed a defect in the carrier analysis at non-CIF resolutions, which mapped macroblocks to frames with the CIF macroblock count and so discarded most of each 4CIF frame; it failed closed (no wrong data, only lost capacity) and was fixed before the 4CIF runs.

C. End-to-end embedding and video-only verification

Table IV reports the end-to-end runs. Every completed run verified from the stego video alone, and in the runs that exercised them a replay of the consumed session and a copy with one flipped bit were both rejected; the payload or credential never appears in the output file. The in-band runs additionally verified a linkage proof between the commitment extracted from the video and a separately committed credential, rejected the linkage to a different credential, and verified a later disclosure of the payload. On modified frames the luma PSNR is 40.0–45.4 dB, the worst frame is 32.1–39.3 dB, and whole-video SSIM is at least 0.9991**[TODO: v2 measurement]**. The worst frames are those in which many carriers fall in smooth regions, where intra prediction spreads a ± 1 change to neighbouring blocks. Embedding takes 6–63 minutes (90 minutes for the concurrently run 3 000-frame in-band case) and verification 2–33 minutes per clip in pure Python; the proof itself takes about 0.1 s**[TODO: v2 measurement]**. QP governs capacity strongly: City 4CIF carries 301 kbit in its first 100 frames at QP 18, so the registered envelope fits one segment (47.7 dB on modified frames, worst 42.8 dB), but only 16 kbit in 600 frames at QP 28, where neither envelope fits. Crew 4CIF has enough carriers in total at QP 22 but too unevenly spread over segments for uniform chunks; at QP 18 it verifies over four segments (48.8 dB, worst 36.6 dB).**[TODO: v2 measurement]**

D. Steganalysis

a) Classical: Targeted tests against the exact cover, on the first 100 frames of each stego video, do not separate cover and stego (Table V): the Westfeld–Pfitzmann pairs-of-values attack on carrier magnitudes [21] returns an embedding probability of zero for both cover and stego, the two-sample magnitude histogram and sign tests give $p \geq 0.998$, and SPA on decoded luma [22] changes in the fourth decimal. RS analysis returned no difference for cover or stego on this content and is not used as evidence.

b) Learned: A learned detector is more effective. We extract, per frame, 340 coefficient-domain features (per-position magnitude histograms, odd-magnitude rates for $|level| \geq 4$, adjacent-position magnitude co-occurrences and per-position sign shares) and 500 pixel-domain features from a reduced spatial rich model [18] (quantized first- and second-order residual co-occurrences), and train logistic regression and an ensemble of shrinkage Fisher linear discriminants on random 30 % feature subspaces (51 members), in the spirit of [19]. The attacker is strong: it trains on exact cover/stego pairs from the same encoder settings and knows which frames carry bits; only modified frames are used. We report the minimum average error $P_E = \min(P_{\mathrm{FA}} + P_{\mathrm{MD}})/2$. With leave-one-clip-out evaluation over five CIF clips (1 300 frame pairs), the best detector reaches $P_E = 0.40$ with coefficient features and 0.45 with pixel features; with clips seen in training (a random split of pairs), the combined features reach 0.36 (Table VI). The embedding is thus detectable per frame at a moderate level in its own domain and barely in the pixel domain. These are per-frame figures; a detector that pools the evidence of all modified frames of a video [23] would do better (Section IX). A GPU-trained CNN with a fixed SRM front end (163k parameters, in the style of Yedrouj-Net [54], 256×256 paired crops, curriculum from an amplified change) does no better: frame $P_E = 0.466$ leave-one-clip-out on 1 700 frame pairs and 0.46–0.47 on a random paired split (two seeds), and 0.41 when its scores are pooled over each 100-frame segment (Table VII). The margin is small: trained and tested on twice the real change, the same network reaches $P_E = 0.18$. Adding the Harbour and Soccer 4CIF runs (seven clips, 1 700 frame pairs) leaves the picture unchanged: leave-one-clip-out

TABLE IV

END-TO-END RUNS WITH THE MAGNITUDE CARRIER. EVERY COMPLETED RUN WAS VERIFIED FROM THE STEGO VIDEO ALONE. PSNR IS LUMA PSNR (DB) AGAINST THE DECODED COVER, COMPUTED FROM THE MEAN MSE OVER MODIFIED FRAMES (MOD), THE WORST FRAME (MIN) AND ALL FRAMES (ALL); SSIM IS OVER THE WHOLE VIDEO. CHECKS: R = REPLAY OF THE CONSUMED SESSION REJECTED, T = A ONE-BIT CHANGE OF THE STEGO FILE REJECTED, L = LINKAGE PROOF TO A CREDENTIAL VERIFIED AND A DIFFERENT CREDENTIAL REJECTED, D = LATER DISCLOSURE OF THE PAYLOAD VERIFIED; – = NOT EXERCISED IN THAT RUN. * 300-FRAME SOURCE LOOPED TO 3 000 FRAMES; THESE TWO RUNS WERE EXECUTED CONCURRENTLY, SO THEIR TIMES ARE INFLATED.

Clip	Res.	QP	Mode	Frames	Seg.	Carriers	Mod. fr.	$\mathrm{PSNR}_{\mathrm{mod}}$	$\mathrm{PSNR}_{\mathrm{min}}$	$\mathrm{PSNR}_{\mathrm{all}}$	SSIM	Embed (s)	Verify (s)	Verified	Checks
City	CIF	22	reg.	300	3	61 600	300	45.35	38.81	45.35	0.99969	903	286	yes	–
Coastguard	CIF	22	reg.	300	2	61 304	200	39.97	33.48	41.73	0.99958	702	271	yes	–
Container	CIF	18	reg.	300	1	61 008	100	43.94	36.41	48.71	0.99989	334	127	yes	–
Container	CIF	22	reg.	300	2	61 304	200	42.07	34.02	43.83	0.99975	580	182	yes	R,T
Deadline	CIF	22	reg.	1000	7	62 784	684	44.99	34.19	46.64	0.99984	1793	1261	yes	R,T
Hall	CIF	22	reg.	300	3	61 600	300	41.48	32.72	41.48	0.99911	613	238	yes	–
Coastguard*	CIF	22	reg.	3000	7	62 784	694	45.26	35.66	51.61	0.99996	2164	740	yes	R,T
City	4CIF	18	reg.	600	1	61 008	100	47.67	42.82	55.45	0.99998	160	115	yes	–
City	4CIF	22	reg.	600	1	61 008	100	43.66	39.31	51.44	0.99995	881	584	yes	R,T
City	4CIF	22	reg.	600	4	61 896	400	49.32	38.17	51.09	0.99994	3248	1309	yes	–
City	4CIF	22	reg.	600	2	61 304	200	45.36	38.61	50.13	0.99994	1443	698	yes	–
Crew	4CIF	18	reg.	600	4	61 896	400	48.81	36.65	50.57	0.99990	478	216	yes	–
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	600	2	61 304	200	42.83	32.91	47.60	0.99994	2357	1954	yes	–
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	600	6	62 488	595	50.74	38.47	50.77	0.99995	915	414	yes	–
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	600	3	61 600	300	45.95	34.98	48.96	0.99994	471	215	yes	–
Soccer	4CIF	22	reg.	600	2	61 304	200	44.64	37.11	49.41	0.99991	310	142	yes	–
Container	CIF	18	in-band	300	2	115 064	200	44.12	38.42	45.88	0.99980	678	465	yes	L,D
Container	CIF	22	in-band	300	3	115 360	300	40.26	32.13	40.26	0.99949	719	466	yes	R,T,L,D
Coastguard*	CIF	22	in-band	3000	12	118 024	1200	45.10	36.02	49.08	0.99992	5409	1707	yes	R,T,L,D
Harbour	4CIF	22	in-band	600	3	115 360	300	41.16	33.15	44.17	0.99987	3760	1108	yes	L,D
Crew	4CIF	22	reg.	skipped by the sweep: envelope does not fit the scanned capacity											
Soccer	4CIF	22	reg.	skipped by the sweep: envelope does not fit the scanned capacity											
City	4CIF	28	reg.	skipped by the sweep: envelope does not fit the scanned capacity											
Crew	4CIF	22	reg.	skipped by the sweep: envelope does not fit the scanned capacity											

$P_E = 0.39$ with coefficient features and 0.46 with pixel features, and 0.38 with combined features on the paired split (`benchmark/results/q2/ml_eval_cif_4cif.json`). **[TODO: v2 measurement]**

E. Carrier choice

We compared the magnitude carrier with the trailing-one sign carrier used by earlier CAVLC schemes [15], through the same pipeline, on four CIF clips, both at the same number of modified frames as the magnitude carrier and packed into 100 frames (Table VIII). All twelve runs verify. Sign carriers are an order of magnitude more plentiful (468–550 kbit per 100 frames). At equal frame count they give higher PSNR on modified frames (43.3–48.8 vs. 40.0–45.4 dB; worst frame 38.5–44.6 vs. 32.7–38.8 dB) but slightly lower whole-video SSIM, and they are much harder to see in the coefficient domain (leave-one-clip-out $P_E = 0.47$ vs. 0.39) yet easier in the pixel domain (0.40 vs. 0.46); with combined features the two are close (0.40 vs. 0.42). The CNN separates them clearly: on sign carriers at the same payload and frame count it reaches $P_E = 0.27$–0.28 leave-one-clip-out and 0.14–0.17 on the paired split, against 0.47 for the magnitude carrier (Table VII); sign carriers should therefore not be presented as secure against learned steganalysis. Packed into 100 frames, sign flips are clearly detectable ($P_E = 0.31$ with pixel features, and a per-position sign test flags one clip at $p = 0.001$). **[TODO: v2 measurement]** Sign carriers were 4–8 times slower to verify at equal frame count (2–3 times when packed into 100 frames), because the reduced stable-carrier analysis does not apply to them; **[TODO: timing of the optimized sign-carrier analysis (t1-sign-video-only-v2) once measured on an idle host]**. We keep the magnitude carrier as the default for verification speed and resistance to learned detectors, and expose the sign carrier as an option when visual quality matters more.

F. Embedding rule and density

Table IX uses simulated embedding on the real carrier positions of the five CIF clips to compare rules and densities with the same detector. LSB matching (± 1 chosen at random) is *more* detectable than replacement ($P_E = 0.27$ vs. 0.32), so replacement is kept. Using 50, 25 and 10 % of the carriers raises P_E to 0.40, 0.44 and 0.47; the envelope can be spread by lowering the chunk size, at the cost of touching more frames. The simulation ignores the patchability filter and is therefore more detectable than the real runs; it supports relative comparisons only. Real registered runs on City and Harbour 4CIF confirm the trend (lower rows of Table IX): at 100, 50 and 25 % of the carriers, the leave-one-clip-out P_E with coefficient features is 0.40, 0.44 and 0.46, the PSNR of modified frames 43.2, 45.7 and 50.0 dB and the worst frame 32.9, 35.0 and 38.2 dB, while the number of modified frames grows from 150 to 500 per clip. All six runs verify from the video alone. **[TODO: v2 measurement]**

G. Syndrome-trellis coded carriers

Because the carrier positions and their number are fixed before the proof exists, the envelope of a segment can be written as the *syndrome* of all stable carriers of that segment instead of into a prefix of them. The

TABLE V
TARGETED CLASSICAL STEGANALYSIS AGAINST THE EXACT COVER (MAGNITUDE CARRIER). PoV: WESTFELD–PFITZMANN EMBEDDING PROBABILITY ON CARRIER MAGNITUDES FOR COVER/STEGO; MAG., T1, POS.: p-VALUES OF TWO-SAMPLE TESTS ON THE MAGNITUDE HISTOGRAM, TRAILING-ONE SIGNS AND PER-SCAN-POSITION SIGNS ($p < 0.05$ WOULD INDICATE DETECTION); SPA: SAMPLE-PAIR ESTIMATE ON DECODED LUMA FOR COVER/STEGO.

Clip	Res.	QP	Mode	Frames	PoV P (c/s)	Mag. p	T1 p	Pos. p	SPA (c/s)
City	4CIF	18	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4169 / 0.4170
City	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	0.998	1.000	1.000	0.3945 / 0.3946
City	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.3945 / 0.3945
City	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.3945 / 0.3945
City	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4076 / 0.4077
Coastguard*	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4066 / 0.4066
Coastguard	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4066 / 0.4067
Container	CIF	18	in-band	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.3314 / 0.3316
Container	CIF	18	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.3314 / 0.3316
Container	CIF	22	in-band	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.2771 / 0.2775
Container	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.2771 / 0.2773
Crew	4CIF	18	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.3119 / 0.3120
Deadline	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.2879 / 0.2881
Hall	CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.2645 / 0.2654
Harbour	4CIF	22	in-band	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4242 / 0.4243
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4242 / 0.4244
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4242 / 0.4242
Harbour	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	1.000	1.000	1.000	0.4242 / 0.4243
Soccer	4CIF	22	reg.	100	0.000 / 0.000	0.997	1.000	1.000	0.3041 / 0.3041

TABLE VI
LEARNED PER-FRAME STEGANALYSIS OF THE MAGNITUDE CARRIER ON 1 300 MODIFIED COVER/STEGO FRAME PAIRS FROM 5 CIF CLIPS ($P_E = 0.5$ IS CHANCE). RANGE: MINIMUM AND MAXIMUM P_E OVER THE HELD-OUT CLIPS.

Features	Detector	Leave-one-clip-out			Paired split	
		P_E	range	AUC	P_E	AUC
Coefficient (340)	logistic	0.407	0.35–0.47	0.604	0.414	0.617
	FLD ens.	0.399	0.34–0.45	0.628	0.394	0.638
Pixel, reduced SRM (500)	logistic	0.454	0.41–0.48	0.538	0.424	0.608
	FLD ens.	0.458	0.42–0.49	0.536	0.410	0.627
Combined (840)	logistic	0.437	0.41–0.47	0.575	0.401	0.633
	FLD ens.	0.422	0.40–0.45	0.583	0.357	0.685

TABLE VII
CNN STEGANALYSIS (SRM FRONT END, YEDROUDJ-STYLE); P_E = 0.5 IS CHANCE. RANGES ARE OVER SEEDS; AMPLIFIED ROWS SCALE THE REAL CHANGE TO GIVE A DETECTION MARGIN.

Carrier	Protocol	Change	Pairs	Seeds	P_E frame	AUC frame	P_E full frame	P_E segment
magnitude	leave-one-clip-out	real	1700	1	0.466	0.529	0.466	0.412
magnitude	paired split	real	1700	2	0.464-0.474	0.528-0.549	0.468-0.476	0.353-0.412
magnitude	paired split	2x amplified	1700	1	0.183	0.904	0.195	0.000
t1-spread	leave-one-clip-out	real	1000	2	0.273-0.278	0.754-0.766	0.194-0.212	0.250-0.400
t1-spread	paired split	real	1000	2	0.142-0.168	0.906-0.931	0.105-0.116	0.000
t1-spread	paired split	2x amplified	1000	1	0.001	1.000	0.001	0.000

contract `adaptive-stc-magnitude-video-only-v1` codes each segment with a syndrome-trellis code [55] of constraint height 10; the embedder's Viterbi search chooses the cheapest set of LSB changes, and the blind extractor reads every carrier and recomputes the syndrome, needing only the carrier count (unchanged by embedding) and the message length from a 14-byte header coded on the first 112 carriers. The carrier set, its keyed order and the statement are unchanged apart from the contract identifier, which the profile identifier binds. Content-based costs computed from carrier-invariant data added 5–35 % more changes than plain change minimization in simulation, so the default cost is uniform.

On 200-frame cuts of three CIF clips with the registered envelope (Table X), STC needs 26–47 % fewer changes (0.27–0.37 instead of 0.50 per envelope bit), gains 1.4–2.4 dB luma PSNR on modified frames, and every run verifies from the video alone at the same cost. Learned detectors do worse against it in every fold and feature set (Table XI): the worst-case P_E rises from 0.41 to 0.43 leave-one-clip-out and from 0.32 to 0.39 on the paired split, while the CNN stays near chance for both (0.457 vs. 0.471).**[TODO: v2 measurement]** With three clips and a fold standard error of about 0.03, the evidence is the consistency of the gain, not its size. The price is fragility: every carrier of a segment enters the code, so one corrupted carrier anywhere invalidates that segment, which the verifier already treats as rejection.

H. Streams with P slices

For Baseline streams with a GOP longer than one, the policy `idr-carriers-inter-raw-v1` places carriers in IDR slices only and binds every P-slice NAL unit byte for byte: the canonical digest hashes their RBSP, and the policy check rejects B/SP/SI slices, data partitioning, slice groups, arbitrary slice order, redundant pictures, CABAC and non-canonical emulation prevention, so binding the RBSP equals binding the bytes. Segments must be whole GOPs, and the policy enters the carrier-profile identifier, so a GOP>1 statement never verifies under the all-intra profile. Table XII reports CIF runs. An IDR carries what an all-intra frame carries, so capacity per frame falls by the GOP length: the 128-bit registered envelope needs about 1 000 frames of Container at GOP 8 and 3 000 at GOP 25 (we use looped sources).**[TODO: v2 measurement]** All runs verify from the video alone, all P slices are unchanged, and flipping one bit inside a P slice is rejected. Drift into P frames barely accumulates (Container loses 0.04–0.09 dB over a GOP), but packing the envelope into fewer pictures lowers quality: modified frames average 39.3–40.8 dB with a worst frame near 32 dB, against 42.1 dB (worst

TABLE VIII
CARRIER COMPARISON THROUGH THE SAME PIPELINE ON FOUR CIF CLIPS (CITY, COASTGUARD, CONTAINER, HALL; QP 22, REGISTERED MODE). RANGES ARE OVER THE FOUR CLIPS. "SAME FRAMES" USES THE CHUNK SIZE OF THE MAGNITUDE RUN, SO BOTH CARRIERS TOUCH THE SAME NUMBER OF FRAMES; "100 FRAMES" PACKS THE ENVELOPE INTO ONE SEGMENT. MIN POS. p: SMALLEST PER-POSITION SIGN-TEST p-VALUE OVER THE CLIPS.

Carrier	Verified	kbit/100 fr.	$\mathrm{PSNR}_{\mathrm{mod}}$	$\mathrm{PSNR}_{\mathrm{min}}$	SSIM	Embed (s)	Verify (s)	min Pos. p	Learned P_E			
									Coef. LOCO	Pixel LOCO	Comb. LOCO	Comb. paired
Magnitude LSB	4/4	21.7–47.9	40.0–45.4	32.7–38.8	0.9991–0.9998	580–903	182–286	1.000	0.386	0.456	0.416	0.339
T1 sign, same frames	4/4	467.6–549.7	43.3–48.8	38.5–44.6	0.9975–0.9994	1275–2329	788–2395	0.981	0.471	0.404	0.401	0.317
T1 sign, 100 frames	4/4	467.6–549.7	41.0–44.1	36.8–40.6	0.9978–0.9994	857–1338	519–816	0.001	0.446	0.310	0.314	0.193

TABLE IX
DETECTABILITY VERSUS EMBEDDING RULE AND DENSITY: LEAVE-ONE-CLIP-OUT, COEFFICIENT FEATURES, FLD ENSEMBLE, FIVE CIF CLIPS. THE UPPER ROWS ARE SIMULATED ON THE REAL CARRIER POSITIONS WITHOUT THE PATCHABILITY FILTER (HENCE MORE DETECTABLE THAN THE REAL RUNS, $P_E = 0.40$); THEY ARE FOR RELATIVE COMPARISON ONLY. THE LOWER ROWS ARE REAL REGISTERED E2E RUNS ON CITY AND HARBOUR 4CIF (LEAVE-ONE-CLIP-OUT OVER THESE TWO CLIPS).

Embedding (fraction of carriers used)	P_E	AUC
Magnitude LSB replacement, 100 %	0.315	0.737
Magnitude LSB replacement, 50 %	0.395	0.627
Magnitude LSB replacement, 25 %	0.443	0.566
Magnitude LSB replacement, 10 %	0.466	0.527
Magnitude LSB matching (± 1), 100 %	0.267	0.801
T1 sign flip, 100 %	0.474	0.512
Measured 4CIF E2E, 100 %	0.403	0.597
Measured 4CIF E2E, 50 %	0.442	0.566
Measured 4CIF E2E, 25 %	0.457	0.545

TABLE X
DIRECT VS. SYNDROME-TRELLIS CODED MAGNITUDE CARRIERS (REGISTERED ENVELOPE, 200-FRAME CIF QP 22 CUTS); EVERY RUN VERIFIES FROM THE VIDEO ALONE.

Clip	Coding	Carriers	Changes	Changes/bit	PSNR mod. (dB)	Worst (dB)	Embed (s)	Verify (s)
coastguard	direct	61304	30673	0.505	40.09	32.65	227	104
coastguard	STC uniform	71303	22618	0.372	41.45	33.93	226	104
coastguard	STC texture	71303	23777	0.392	41.16	33.31	232	104
container	direct	61304	30491	0.502	42.27	34.35	179	80
container	STC uniform	101439	16167	0.266	44.07	36.51	179	83
container	STC texture	101439	19125	0.315	44.09	35.65	187	80
deadline	direct	61304	30531	0.503	37.67	28.74	184	84
deadline	STC uniform	95332	16750	0.276	40.06	32.48	231	101
deadline	STC texture	95332	19304	0.318	38.58	29.41	204	83

34.0 dB) for all-intra Container at the same payload.**[TODO: v2 measurement]** Only IDR slices are parsed, so verification is cheap per frame.

I. Comparison with alternative proof systems

Table XIII compares schemes that could carry the claim. Groth16 is more than fifty times smaller but not post-quantum and needs a circuit-specific trusted setup. ML-DSA signatures are post-quantum and smaller, but a signature reveals the signed data or binds a public value; it proves nothing about a hidden payload and supports neither later linkage nor selective disclosure. ISW21 is a lattice zkSNARK with a designated verifier, statistical zero knowledge of only 2^{-40} in the configuration we ran, a 2.4 MB verifier key, and an analysis based on an assumption invalidated against quantum adversaries [38]; its envelope is also larger. The BDLOP opening proof is the smallest transparent, publicly verifiable, zero-knowledge option we found that fits the measured capacity.

TABLE XI
LEARNED STEGANALYSIS P_E FOR DIRECT AND SYNDROME-TRELLIS CODED CARRIERS (600 FRAME PAIRS PER MODE).

Protocol	Features / detector	direct	STC uniform	STC texture
leave-one-clip-out	coefficient/logistic	0.451	0.460	0.451
leave-one-clip-out	coefficient/fld_ensemble	0.406	0.431	0.404
leave-one-clip-out	pixel/logistic	0.443	0.461	0.461
leave-one-clip-out	pixel/fld_ensemble	0.412	0.450	0.443
leave-one-clip-out	combined/logistic	0.435	0.466	0.453
leave-one-clip-out	combined/fld_ensemble	0.407	0.438	0.427
paired split	coefficient/logistic	0.388	0.418	0.425
paired split	coefficient/fld_ensemble	0.352	0.392	0.393
paired split	pixel/logistic	0.392	0.422	0.420
paired split	pixel/fld_ensemble	0.368	0.412	0.403
paired split	combined/logistic	0.350	0.395	0.377
paired split	combined/fld_ensemble	0.323	0.388	0.353
leave-one-clip-out	worst case	0.406	0.431	0.404
paired split	worst case	0.323	0.388	0.353

TABLE XII
GOP > 1 STREAMS: CARRIERS IN IDR SLICES ONLY, P SLICES BOUND BYTE FOR BYTE (CIF, QP 22, REGISTERED). THE 413-BYTE ROWS USE THE TOY PARAMETER SET TO FIT SHORT CLIPS; THE 7 589-BYTE ROWS USE `BDLOP-OPEN-128-V1` ON LOOPED SOURCES.

Clip	GOP	Frames	Envelope (B)	kbit/100 fr.	P-slice tamper rej.	Frames mod.	PSNR all (dB)	PSNR mod. (dB)	Worst (dB)	Embed (s)	Verify (s)
container	1	200	413	50.8	–	100	63.71	60.70	55.58	46	42
container	8	200	413	6.4	yes	104	47.02	44.18	40.91	8	6
container	25	200	413	2.0	yes	200	39.24	39.24	32.02	11	5
foreman	1	300	413	14.2	–	100	58.87	54.09	42.39	16	13
foreman	8	300	413	1.8	yes	300	53.21	53.21	44.57	14	6
coastguard	8	3000	7589	4.5	yes	1588	42.40	39.64	31.96	270	140
container	8	3000	7589	6.2	yes	1400	44.11	40.80	32.63	179	77
container	25	6000	7589	2.0	yes	3600	41.49	39.27	32.73	167	71

IX. DISCUSSION AND LIMITATIONS

a) Relaxed soundness: The extractor yields a relaxed opening $(\bar{r}, f)$ rather than a ternary opening, so the payload is bound only through binding with respect to relaxed openings. This is standard for Fiat–Shamir-with-aborts proofs, but the statement "the holder knows the payload" must be read in this relaxed sense.

b) Random-oracle model: The argument is in the classical random-oracle model with a non-tight forking reduction. We do not claim security in the quantum random-oracle model; generic results for Fiat–Shamir [46], [47] make a post-quantum interpretation plausible but do not give concrete bounds for our parameters.

c) Implementation: The code is a research prototype implemented by us from the published protocol. It has not been audited and is not constant time (Python big-integer arithmetic and data-dependent rejection loops); timing side channels are out of scope.

d) Framing malleability: The envelope bytes are integrity-protected: changing any of them makes the proof or the statement fail. The chunk framing around them is bound as well: the verifier re-chunks the extracted envelope under

TABLE XIII

PROOF AND SIGNATURE SCHEMES THAT COULD CARRY THE CLAIM, ON THE SAME HOST (SINGLE THREAD). SIZE: BYTES CARRIED IN THE VIDEO (ENVELOPE OR PROOF-BEARING PAYLOAD); THE EQUALITY PROOF IS EXCHANGED OUT OF BAND AT LINKAGE TIME. BDLOP TIMINGS ARE MEDIANS OF 50 RUNS ON AN IDLE MACHINE (PURE PYTHON); GROTH16 IS END-TO-END WALL TIME THROUGH A PYTHON BRIDGE (3 TRIALS); ML-DSA VIA PQCRYPTO. ISW21 NUMBERS WERE RECORDED EARLIER IN A LINUX CONTAINER ON THE SAME CPU (TOY 32-BYTE RELATION) AND NOT RE-RUN. ‡ THE OBLIVIOUS-LWE-SAMPLING ASSUMPTION USED IN ITS ANALYSIS IS INVALIDATED AGAINST QUANTUM ADVERSARIES [38].

Scheme	Assumption	ZK	Hides payload	Size (B)	Prove (ms)	Verify (ms)	Setup
This work, registered	M-SIS/M-LWE	yes	yes	7589	120	22	transparent
This work, in-band	M-SIS/M-LWE	yes	yes	14 309	120	22	transparent
Equality (linkage) proof	M-SIS/M-LWE	yes	–	15 008	968	46	transparent
Groth16 (BN128)	none (pairings)	yes	yes	147	7222	2550	per-circuit trusted
ML-DSA-44 signature	M-LWE/M-SIS	no	no	2420	18.6	0.33	none
ML-DSA-65 signature	M-LWE/M-SIS	no	no	3309	25.3	0.52	none
ISW21 (recorded)	lattice + knowledge‡	stat. 2^{-40}	yes	23 907	328	0.6	trusted, designated

the pinned chunk size and rejects unless the extracted chunks are exactly that encoding. Without this check, an envelope that fits in a single chunk left the 16-bit chunk-size field free, so carrier bits could be changed while the same envelope verified.

e) Stego key versus public order: Undetectability requires a symmetric key shared with the verifier, which makes verification designated in practice. The public-order mode makes verification public and gives up undetectability. The keyed permutation that orders carriers is derived from an HMAC-SHA-256 seed but uses a chaotic-map shuffle, which is not a cryptographic pseudorandom permutation; replacing it with a standard keyed permutation is straightforward and does not affect the proof.

f) Per-frame versus per-video detection: The learned detector's per-frame error of 0.40**[TODO: v2 measurement]** means that each modified frame leaks a little; a video carries 100–1 200 modified frames, and pooling their scores would likely detect the embedding with high confidence. We have not quantified a pooled detector. Spreading the envelope over more frames lowers per-frame density but increases the number of frames that leak; reducing the number of changes, as the syndrome-trellis coding of Section VIII-G does, lowers the leakage of every frame and is the more promising direction.

g) Capacity and codec scope: Only Baseline (CAVLC) streams are supported; streams with P slices carry the proof in IDR slices only (Section VIII-H), which divides capacity by the GOP length. A registered envelope needs 65.3 kbit, which smooth content and high QP do not provide within a few hundred frames. Appendix C gives a proof that a commitment under the same parameter set hides a binary string (43 022 bytes; 2.2 s to prove and 72 ms to verify, measured with `bdlop-binary-128-v1`**[TODO: v2 measurement]**), built from lifted constant-coefficient relations and an ALS20-style product step [27], [29] that works on our two-slot ring. It is not yet tied to the 24-bit payload encoding, which would need a bit-decomposition proof, and its multi-round Fiat–Shamir-with-aborts composition is argued but not written out; range proofs on the payload remain open.

h) What is claimed: An accepted video shows that its producer knew a (relaxed) opening of the bound commitment for this exact carrier-normalized video, carrier layout, registry entry and session; in registered mode, that the producer holds the registered credential. It does not show that the payload is true, that a camera recorded the video, or, in in-band mode, who produced it. The session challenge is not secret, so it should be delivered over an authenticated channel if the holder's identity matters.

X. THREATS TO VALIDITY

a) Internal validity: The protocol, parser and patcher were implemented by the authors; correctness is supported by unit and negative tests, known-answer vectors and the end-to-end verification itself, but not by an independent implementation. Quality is measured against the decoded cover, not the raw source, which isolates the embedding from the encoder. Timings come from a single host; two long runs were executed concurrently and are marked. The density and rule comparisons are simulations that omit the patchability filter.

b) Construct validity: P_E is a per-frame measure on modified frames only, which favours the attacker within a frame but ignores pooling across frames. PSNR on modified frames depends on how many frames an envelope touches, which in turn depends on the chosen chunk size. Capacity for partly scanned clips is extrapolated from the scanned segments.

c) External validity: The evaluation uses a small set of standard CIF and 4CIF sequences, one encoder (x264), the Baseline profile, all-intra coding (plus short-GOP runs on looped CIF sources) and fixed QP. Results may differ for camera footage, other encoders, rate control, long GOPs or higher resolutions. The detectors are feature-based; a stronger learned detector may lower P_E.

d) Conclusion validity: Learned results are averaged over five held-out clips with no confidence intervals; we report the range over folds instead. With few clips, differences of a few hundredths in P_E between configurations should not be over-interpreted.

XI. CONCLUSION

A post-quantum zero-knowledge proof can travel inside an H.264 CAVLC bitstream, bound to that bitstream through a carrier-normalized commitment and to a verifier session, and be verified from the video alone. With a 7.6 kB registered envelope and a 14.3 kB in-band envelope, textured CIF and 4CIF content carries the proof in one to three hundred frames at 40–45 dB on modified frames, and classical targeted steganalysis does not detect it. A learned per-frame detector does

better than chance, and the security argument rests on relaxed soundness in the classical random-oracle model. The next steps are cost-aware carrier selection against learned and pooled detectors, tying the binary proof to the payload encoding, carriers inside P slices and an evaluation at HD resolutions, and an independent review of the cryptographic argument.

ARTIFACT AVAILABILITY

The implementation, the specification with known-answer vectors, the parameter-estimation scripts, all result files used in this paper and the script that regenerates its tables are available in an anonymized repository: **[TODO: anonymized repository URL]**. Test videos are derived from the public Xiph sequences with the provided encoding commands; the large intermediate files are not redistributed.

APPENDIX A
SECURITY PROOFS

A. Conventions

Random oracles are sampled lazily. A point of H_{fs} is *defined* once it has been queried or programmed; a query at an undefined point is *fresh*. Q_H bounds all random-oracle queries of the adversary, including the verifier's queries in $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Ver}}$ and one final verification, and Q_P the number of honest proofs. Every reduction below runs the whole experiment itself, which it can do because verification is public and every honest commitment is generated by the challenger. For the key-expansion oracle there is a single point (the key tag followed by pid); a reduction that must plant a challenge matrix programs this point before the adversary starts, which makes ck distributed exactly as a uniform key.

B. Proof of Lemma 2

Fix $r \in S_1^k$ and $c \in \mathcal{C}$, and let $v = cr \in \mathbb{Z}^{kN}$ be the integer negacyclic product. Since $\|v\|_\infty \le \|c\|_1\|r\|_\infty \le \kappa < q/2$, centering the product modulo q recovers v exactly, which is what the implementation computes (`opening_proof.py:79-80`). For one coordinate and any $a \in [-B, B]$, $\Pr[y_i + v_i = a] = \Pr[y_i = a - v_i] = 1/2\gamma$, because $a - v_i \in [-B - \kappa, B + \kappa] = [-\gamma + 1, \gamma - 1]$ lies in the mask range. The coordinates are independent, so $\Pr[z = z_0] = (2\gamma)^{-kN}$ for every $z_0 \in Z$. Summing over Z gives acceptance probability $|Z|(2\gamma)^{-kN} = p_{\mathrm{acc}}$, and conditioned on acceptance z is uniform on Z; neither depends on r or c. □

C. Proof of Lemma 3

Real prover (`opening_proof.py:86-109`). On (x, t, r): draw $e \leftarrow \{0,1\}^{256}$; $K = H_{\mathsf{hg}}(e \| \text{length-prefixed } x, t, r)$; for $i = 1, \ldots, A_{\max}$: $y_i = H_{\mathsf{y}}(K\|i) \in Y$, $w_i = B_1 y_i$, $h_i = H_{\mathsf{fs}}(pid, x, t, w_i)$, $c_i = G(h_i)$, $z_i = y_i + c_i r$; output (h_i, z_i) at the first i with $z_i \in Z$, or $\perp$ after $A_{\max}$ rejections.

Simulator $\mathcal{S}(x, t)$. Output $\perp$ with probability $(1-p_{\mathrm{acc}})^{A_{\max}}$. Otherwise draw $h \leftarrow \{0,1\}^{256}$ and $z \leftarrow Z$, set $w = B_1 z - G(h)t_1$; if H_{fs} is defined at (pid, x, t, w), abort; else program $H_{\mathsf{fs}}(pid, x, t, w) := h$ and output (h, z). The simulator never uses r.

We bound the change per proof; a union bound over the Q_P proofs gives the lemma. Write $\eta_y = nN \log_2(2\gamma)$. Because $B_1 = [I_n | B_1']$, the first n rows of $w = B_1 y$ are $y_{[1..n]} + B_1' y_{[n+1..k]}$, a bijective image of $y_{[1..n]}$ for fixed $y_{[n+1..k]}$; hence $H_\infty(w) \ge \eta_y$ for a uniform mask, $H_\infty(w) \ge \eta_y - \log_2 \frac{1}{1-p_{\mathrm{acc}}} \ge \eta$ for a mask conditioned on rejection, and $H_\infty(w) \ge \eta$ for a simulated $w = B_1 z - ct_1$ with z uniform on Z.

G_0: the real prover.

G_1: K is replaced by a uniform value. The games differ only if some query to H_{hg} other than the prover's own starts with e: at most $(Q_H + Q_P)2^{-256}$.

G_2: each y_i is replaced by a fresh uniform element of Y. The games differ only if H_{y} is queried elsewhere at $K\|i$: at most $(Q_H + Q_P)2^{-256}$.

G_3: in a rejected attempt the prover draws h_i uniformly and sets $c_i = G(h_i)$ without querying or defining H_{fs}. The games differ only if the point (pid, x, t, w_i) is, at any time, queried by $\mathcal{A}$ or defined by another honest proof: at most $A_{\max}(Q_H + A_{\max}Q_P)2^{-\eta}$. This is the step that concerns the hidden random-oracle queries of rejected attempts [44], [45].

G_4: the accepted attempt's point is defined by the prover's query; it is fresh except with probability $(Q_H + (A_{\max} + 1)Q_P)2^{-\eta}$. Conditioned on freshness, h_i is uniform in every attempt and, by Lemma 2, attempt i is accepted with probability exactly p_{acc} whatever h_i, c_i and r. So the index of the first acceptance is truncated-geometric, and given acceptance, h is uniform and z is uniform on Z, independent of each other and of r. Rejected attempts are not linked to any oracle after G_3 and can be dropped. The output and the oracle definition $H_{\mathsf{fs}}(pid, x, t, B_1 z - G(h)t_1) = h$ are then distributed exactly as in $\mathcal{S}$, whose abort event is the non-freshness event just bounded.

The total per proof is $2(Q_H + Q_P)2^{-256} + (A_{\max} + 1)(Q_H + (A_{\max} + 1)Q_P)2^{-\eta}$.

For Π_{eq} (`equality_proof.py:58-104`) the prover draws two masks per attempt, announces $(w_a, w_b, u) = (B_1 y_a, B_1 y_b, \langle b_2, y_a - y_b\rangle)$ and accepts iff both responses are in Z. By Lemma 2 applied to each response, acceptance has probability exactly p_{acc}^2 and the accepted (z_a, z_b) is uniform on Z^2. The simulator samples (h, z_a, z_b), sets $w_a = B_1 z_a - ct_{1,a}$, $w_b = B_1 z_b - ct_{1,b}$, $u = \langle b_2, z_a - z_b\rangle - c(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b})$ and programs H_{eq}; the announcement has min-entropy at least η through w_a. The same hybrids give the same bound. □

D. A forking extraction lemma

Lemma 6 (Extraction)**.** *Let $\mathcal{B}$ be an algorithm with coins ρ that makes at most Q fresh queries to H_{fs}, answered by $h_1, \ldots, h_Q \leftarrow \{0,1\}^{256}$ (the oracle G and all points programmed by $\mathcal{B}$ are determined by ρ). $\mathcal{B}$ outputs $\perp$ or (J, x^*, t^*, π^*) such that $\pi^* = (h_J, z^*)$ is accepted for (x^*, t^*) and the J-th fresh query is (pid, x^*, t^*, w^*) with $w^* = B_1 z^* - G(h_J)t_1^*$. Let* $\mathrm{acc} = \Pr[\mathcal{B} \ne \perp]$. *There is $\mathcal{E}$, running $\mathcal{B}$ twice, that outputs x^* of the first run and a relaxed opening of t^**

with probability $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} \geq \mathrm{acc}(\mathrm{acc}/Q - 2^{-256}) - 2^{-257} - Q2^{-256}$*; equivalently*

$$\mathrm{acc} \leq Q2^{-256} + \sqrt{Q\big(\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} + 2^{-257} + Q2^{-256}\big)}.$$

Proof. $\mathcal{E}$ is the forking algorithm of Bellare and Neven [52] (Lemma 1, the general forking lemma; see also [56]): run $\mathcal{B}(\rho; h_1..h_Q)$; if it returns J, rerun it on $(\rho; h_1..h_{J-1}, h'_J..h'_Q)$ with fresh $h'_J, \ldots, h'_Q$; succeed if the second run returns the same J and $h'_J \neq h_J$. That lemma gives success probability at least $\mathrm{acc}(\mathrm{acc}/Q - 2^{-256})$. Both runs are identical up to the J-th fresh query, so they share (x^*, t^*, w^*), and return (h_J, z), (h'_J, z') with $B_1 z - c t_1^* = w^* = B_1 z' - c' t_1^*$ for $c = G(h_J)$, $c' = G(h'_J)$. The value h'_J is uniform and independent of the first run; unless it is one of the at most Q inputs at which G was evaluated in the first run (probability $\leq Q2^{-256}$), $G(h'_J)$ is a fresh uniform element of $\mathcal{C}$ and equals c with probability $1/|\mathcal{C}| \leq 2^{-257}$. Otherwise $f = c - c' \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$ and $\bar{r} = z - z'$ satisfy $\|\bar{r}\|_\infty \leq 2B$ and $B_1 \bar{r} = f t_1^*$. The second form follows by solving the quadratic inequality: $\mathrm{acc}^2 - Q2^{-256}\mathrm{acc} - Q\delta \leq 0$ with $\delta = \varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} + 2^{-257} + Q2^{-256}$ implies $\mathrm{acc} \leq Q2^{-256} + \sqrt{Q\delta}$. □

E. Proof of Theorem 1

G_0 is SE. In G_1 every honest proof is produced by the simulator, so $|\Pr[W_0] - \Pr[W_1]| \leq \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P, Q_H)$, where W_i is the winning event. Let Prog be the event that $\mathcal{A}$ wins in G_1 and the verifier's point (pid, x^*, t^*, w^*) was programmed by the simulator, for a triple $(x_i, t_i, \pi_i) \in L$. Then $x^* = x_i$, $t^* = t_i$, $w^* = w_i$, and acceptance forces $h^* = h_i$, so $c^* = c_i$. As $(x^*, t^*, \pi^*) \notin L$, we have $z^* \neq z_i$, and $B_1 z^* - c_i t_1^* = B_1 z_i - c_i t_1^*$ gives $B_1(z^* - z_i) = 0$ with $0 < \|z^* - z_i\|_\infty \leq 2B \leq \beta$. An M-SIS adversary that plants its matrix as B'_1, draws b'_2 itself, runs G_1 and outputs $z^* - z_i$ succeeds whenever Prog occurs, so $\Pr[\mathsf{Prog}] \leq \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}}$. Otherwise the verifier's point is defined by a fresh query, and $\mathcal{B}$ (which runs G_1 and outputs the index of that query) satisfies the hypothesis of Lemma 6 with $Q = Q_H$ and $\mathrm{acc} \geq \varepsilon - \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}} - \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}}$. Substituting gives the theorem.

The forked query contains x^*, which the verifier builds from its pins and from $\mathsf{Read}(\mathsf{vid}^*)$ (`video_pipeline.py:278-284`); it never takes a statement field from the prover except N_s^*, which it checks against its store (or against the fixed value) and which is itself part of x^*. The extracted opening is therefore bound to the verifier's values of rid, pid, registry root and epoch, N_s, codec policy, carrier profile, $|P|$, $\mathrm{SHA256}(P)$ and V. Two statements that differ in any field differ as strings, since every field has a fixed width (`video_proof.py:68-77`). □

F. Proof of Theorem 2

Let $(\bar{r}, f, m)$ and $(\bar{r}', f', m')$ open t with $m \neq m'$, where an honest opening has $f = 1$ and $\|\bar{r}\|_\infty \leq 1$. From $f t_1 = B_1 \bar{r}$ and $f' t_1 = B_1 \bar{r}'$ we get $B_1 x = 0$ for $x = f'\bar{r} - f\bar{r}'$. From $f t_2 = \langle b_2, \bar{r}\rangle + fm$ and $f' t_2 = \langle b_2, \bar{r}'\rangle + f'm'$,

$$\langle b_2, x\rangle = f'(f t_2 - fm) - f(f' t_2 - f' m') = f f'(m' - m).$$

If $x \equiv 0 \pmod q$ then $f f'(m' - m) = 0$ and, f and f' being invertible (Lemma 1; 1 trivially), $m = m'$, a contradiction. The norm of x is at most $\|f'\|_1 \|\bar{r}\|_\infty + \|f\|_1 \|\bar{r}'\|_\infty$, i.e. $2\kappa \cdot 2B + 2\kappa \cdot 2B = 8\kappa B$ for two relaxed openings, $2\kappa \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 2B$ for one relaxed and one honest, and 2 for two honest openings. All are at most $\beta < q/2$ (the parameter constructor enforces $2\beta < q$, `params.py:53-54`), so x is a nonzero short vector both modulo q and over $\mathbb{Z}$. The reduction plants its matrix as B'_1, samples b'_2 and outputs x. □

G. Proof of Lemma 4

Lemma 7 (Hiding instance)**.** *There is an efficient map that, for any m chosen after seeing ck, sends an M-LWE instance (A, u), $A \in \mathcal{R}_q^{(n+1)\times\lambda}$, to (ck, t) with ck uniform, such that $t = \mathsf{Com}(m; r)$ with $r \leftarrow S_1^k$ if $u = As + e$, and t is uniform if u is uniform.*

Proof. Write $A = \left[\begin{smallmatrix} A_1 \\ a_2 \end{smallmatrix}\right]$ and $u = (u_1, u_2)$. Draw $B'_{1,2} \leftarrow \mathcal{R}_q^{n\times 1}$ and set $b'_2 = a_2$, $B'_{1,3} = A_1 + B'_{1,2} a_2$, which makes ck uniform. Given m, set $t_2 = u_2 + m$ and $t_1 = u_1 + B'_{1,2} u_2$. If $u = As + e$ with $e = (e_1, e_2)$ and $r = (e_1, e_2, s)$, then $\langle b_2, r\rangle = e_2 + a_2 s = u_2$ and $B_1 r = e_1 + B'_{1,2} e_2 + (A_1 + B'_{1,2} a_2) s = u_1 + B'_{1,2} u_2$, so $t = \mathsf{Com}(m; r)$ with r uniform ternary. If u is uniform, so is t, because $(u_1, u_2) \mapsto (u_1 + B'_{1,2} u_2, u_2 + m)$ is a bijection. □

Now let $\mathcal{A}$ output $(j, \bar{r}, f)$ with $f \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$, $\|\bar{r}\|_\infty \leq 2B$ and $f t_1^{(j)} = B_1 \bar{r}$, and put $x = f r_j - \bar{r}$. Then $B_1 x = f t_1^{(j)} - f t_1^{(j)} = 0$ and $\|x\|_\infty \leq 2\kappa + 2B < q/2$.

Case $x \neq 0$. An M-SIS adversary plants its matrix as B'_1, samples b'_2, generates every $t^{(j)}$ itself (so it knows every r_j), and outputs x. Hence $\Pr[x \neq 0] \leq \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}}$.

Case $x = 0$. Then $\bar{r} \equiv f r_j$, so r_j is the centered representative of $f^{-1}\bar{r} \bmod q$. An M-LWE distinguisher guesses $j_0 \leftarrow [Q]$, builds ck and $t^{(j_0)}$ from its instance by Lemma 7 (with the message m_{j_0} that $\mathcal{A}$ chooses), generates the other commitments honestly, and outputs 1 iff $\mathcal{A}$ returns $j = j_0$ and $r' = \mathrm{center}(f^{-1}\bar{r})$ is ternary with $\mathsf{Com}(m_{j_0}; r') = t^{(j_0)}$. On a real instance it outputs 1 with probability at least $\Pr[x = 0]/Q$. On a uniform instance $t^{(j_0)}$ is uniform and independent of m_{j_0}, so a ternary opening exists with probability at most $|S_1^k|/q^{(n+1)N} = 3^{kN} q^{-(n+1)N}$. Hence $\Pr[x = 0] \leq Q(\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}LWE}} + 3^{kN} q^{-(n+1)N})$. □

H. Proof of Theorem 3

H_0 is IND^0. In H_1 all honest proofs, including the challenge proof, are simulated: $|H_0 - H_1| \leq \varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P + 1, Q_H)$. In H_2 the challenge commitment is replaced by a uniform pair; a distinguisher between H_1 and H_2 is an M-LWE distinguisher by Lemma 7 with $m = \mathsf{enc}(p_0)$: it builds ck from its instance, generates the other commitments honestly, answers $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Disc}}$ and $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Link}}$ for them, and the challenge randomness is never needed because the challenge proof is simulated and disclosure and linkage of the challenge are excluded. So $|H_1 - H_2| \leq \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}LWE}}$. The stego video in H_2 is $\mathsf{Write}(\mathsf{vid}, P, E)$ with P, D, x independent of the payload (fixed from a placeholder of the final length, `video_pipeline.py:216-227`), and E contains only pid, N_s, a uniform t and a simulated proof;

H_2 is therefore independent of b. The same three hybrids from IND^1 end in the same H_2, which gives the bound. The payload length is hidden because enc maps every payload of at most 766 bytes to one polynomial and the envelope has a fixed size. □

I. Proof of Theorem 4

We model the store as a linearizable table keyed by $d(N) = \mathrm{SHA256}(\mathrm{tag}\|N)$ (`zkp_sessions.py:113–117`). Rows are inserted only by Issue with a fresh uniform N (`:132–151`) and deleted only once expired (`:140–143`). Acceptance requires the preflight `is_active` and then `consume`, an `UPDATE` with the conditions `consumed_at IS NULL`, matching binding and `expires_at>now`, committed inside `BEGIN IMMEDIATE`, returning success iff exactly one row changed (`:181–205`).

(i) After the first successful `consume` of a row, the condition `consumed_at IS NULL` fails for that row forever; a second success for the same N_s needs another row with key $d(N_s)$, i.e. a later issuance of some N' with $d(N') = d(N_s)$: either $N' = N_s$ (probability at most $Q_I^2 2^{-257}$ over all pairs of issuances) or a SHA-256 collision. (ii) Any row with key $d(N_s^*)$ comes from an issuance of some N with $d(N) = d(N_s^*)$, so N_s^* was issued unless SHA-256 collides; the binding and expiry are part of the `WHERE` clause, evaluated at consumption time. (iii) The session field occupies bytes 106–137 (0-indexed) of every statement, and x^* is a substring of the point (pid, x^*, t^*, w^*). A query made before the issuance of N_s^* fixes this field before N_s^* is drawn, so it matches with probability 2^{-256}; a union bound over Q_H queries and Q_I sessions gives $Q_H Q_I 2^{-256}$. □

J. Proof of Theorem 5

Let W_a, W_b be the two winning cases.

W_a: Pins verifies Reg^* under pk_I (`video_pipeline.py:146–147`). If its signing bytes were never signed through $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Reg}}$, it is an EUF-CMA forgery; the reduction runs the whole experiment, using its signing oracle for $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Reg}}$. Otherwise Reg^* is a signed registry and contains a descriptor equal to the registered descriptor of t^* (`:150–153`). That descriptor has the registered constraint-module hash, so it is not in any Δ (in-band descriptors have a different module hash, unless SHA-256 collides on the two fixed module strings), and it was computed from some $t' \in T_{\mathsf{reg}}$. Since $t^* \notin T_{\mathsf{reg}}$, $t' \neq t^*$ and the canonical encodings differ, so $\mathrm{SHA256}(B_1'\|b_2'\|t^*) = \mathrm{SHA256}(B_1'\|b_2'\|t')$ (`:119–128`) is a collision. Hence $\Pr[W_a] \le \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{euf\text{-}cma}}_{\mathsf{ML\text{-}DSA}} + \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{cr}}_{\mathsf{SHA2}}$.

W_b: simulate all honest proofs ($\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}$) and handle the programmed-point case as in Theorem 1 ($\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}}$). The remaining runner $\mathcal{B}$ receives the honest credentials as a Q_C-instance challenge of Lemma 4, never uses their randomness (all proofs are simulated, and a disclosure query for an instance aborts the run, which does not affect runs in which $\mathcal{A}$ wins with an undisclosed j), and outputs the index of the verifier's fresh query. Lemma 6 extracts a relaxed opening of $t^* = t_c^{(j)}$, which is a Lemma 4 adversary, so $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} \le \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{row}}_{Q_C}$. Adding the cases gives the theorem.

A tight alternative for W_b follows the ML-DSA analysis: after replacing the credential by a uniform pair (M-LWE), an accepted proof is a solution of the SelfTargetMSIS problem for $[B_1 \,|\, t_1]$ and H_{fs} [53], without rewinding. We state the rewinding bound because it uses only the estimated M-SIS and M-LWE instances. □

K. Proofs for linkage (Theorem 6)

Lemma 8 (Special soundness of the equality proof)**.** *Two accepting transcripts $((w_a, w_b, u), c, z_a, z_b)$ and $((w_a, w_b, u), c', z_a', z_b')$ with $c \neq c'$ yield relaxed openings $(\bar r_a, f)$ of t_a and $(\bar r_b, f)$ of t_b, $f = c - c'$, with equal messages.*

Proof. The verifier checks $B_1 z_a = w_a + c t_{1,a}$, $B_1 z_b = w_b + c t_{1,b}$ and $\langle b_2, z_a - z_b\rangle = u + c(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b})$ (`equality_proof.py:135–145`). Subtracting the two transcripts gives $B_1 \bar r_a = f t_{1,a}$, $B_1 \bar r_b = f t_{1,b}$ and $\langle b_2, \bar r_a - \bar r_b\rangle = f(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b})$ with $\bar r_* = z_* - z_*'$, $\|\bar r_*\|_\infty \le 2B$. Then $\bar m_a - \bar m_b = (t_{2,a} - t_{2,b}) - f^{-1}\langle b_2, \bar r_a - \bar r_b\rangle = 0$. □

Soundness. Simulate $\mathcal{O}_{\mathsf{Link}}$ ($\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}$). If the verifier's H_{eq} point was programmed for the same context and commitments, then c is the programmed one and $(z_a, z_b) \neq (z_a^{(i)}, z_b^{(i)})$ with $B_1(z_a - z_a^{(i)}) = B_1(z_b - z_b^{(i)}) = 0$, an M-SIS solution of norm $2B$. Otherwise Lemma 6, with the forked oracle H_{eq} and Lemma 8 in place of the opening relation, extracts openings with a common message $\bar m$. The adversary's first-run openings have messages $m_a \neq m_b$, so $m_a \neq \bar m$ or $m_b \neq \bar m$, and Theorem 2 applied to t_a or t_b gives an M-SIS solution. Hence $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{ext}} \le \mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}}$ in the bound of Theorem 1.

Hiding. Simulate the proof ($\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}}(Q_P + 1, Q_H)$), then replace t_a and t_b by uniform pairs, one M-LWE hybrid each (Lemma 7; the randomness is independent). The final game is independent of b; doing the same from $b = 1$ gives $2\varepsilon_{\mathsf{zk}} + 4\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}LWE}}$.

Disclosure by proof. The equality proof with $t_b = (0, \mathsf{enc}(p))$ and $r_b = 0$ (a ternary opening of t_b) proves that t_a hides p without revealing r_a: extraction gives a relaxed opening $(\bar r_b, f)$ of t_b with $B_1 \bar r_b = 0$, so $\bar r_b = 0$ unless M-SIS is broken, and then $\bar m_b = \mathsf{enc}(p) = \bar m_a$. This is the fix proposed for item D3. □

L. Proof of Lemma 5 and Theorem 7

Unique decodability. For a carrier segment the hashed string is the domain tag followed, for each NAL unit, by `"NAL\0"` and a fixed 12-byte header, then either `"RAW\0"`, a 64-bit length and the RBSP, or a sequence of `"BITS\0"`, a 64-bit bit count and the packed bits, alternating with `"BLOCK\0"`, the 16-byte key and length, and the signed 64-bit levels (`video_canonicalization.py:234–307`). The four tags differ in their first two bytes, every field is fixed-width or length-prefixed, and the padding of packed bits is determined by the bit count, so a left-to-right parser recovers the whole sequence. The

segment combiner hashes a tag, the 32-bit frames-per-segment and segment count, and fixed-width (i, f_i, d_i) triples (`blind_sync_streaming.py:225-233`); V hashes a tag and D. A difference in Canon is therefore a difference in the input of one of the three SHA-256 layers whose outputs are equal, which is a collision. Carrier segments are exactly those containing positions of P, so for equal P both sides hash each segment in the same mode.

What is determined. Fix Canon and P. Segments without carriers are fixed byte for byte. In a carrier segment, every NAL header field in the serialization, every RBSP of a NAL unit without carriers, and every RBSP bit outside carrier blocks up to the stop bit are fixed. Each carrier block is fixed as a level vector except at carriers, where only the normalized value $\nu = \operatorname{sgn}(\ell)2\lfloor|\ell|/2\rfloor$ is fixed. The pipeline enforces the stable rule (`blind_sync_streaming.py:268-271`; carriers have $|\ell| \geq 4$ and the embedder flips the magnitude parity), so $\ell = \nu + \operatorname{sgn}(\nu)b$ with b the carrier bit; for the optional trailing-one sign carrier, $\ell = \pm 1$ with the sign as the bit. The carrier bits are written in the order of P as the chunk-framed encoding of E. If that encoding is unique, E fixes the bits and hence every carrier level.

Theorem 7. Let $(x_h, t, \pi_h) \in L$ be the honest triple. If $(x^*, t, \pi^*) \notin L$, the event is bounded as in Theorem 5, case W_b, with the Q_P honest commitments as the Lemma 4 instances. Otherwise $x^* = x_h$ and $\pi^* = \pi_h$ (each honest in-band commitment occurs in one triple except with negligible probability; a credential occurs in several, all honest). Equal statements give equal $|P|$ and $\mathrm{SHA256}(P)$, hence $P^* = P_h$ unless SHA-256 collides (the positions are hashed as canonical JSON of integer triples), and equal V, hence equal Canon by the first part. The envelope is $E^* = \mathtt{magic}\|1\|pid\|N_s\|t\|\pi^*$, and its parser accepts only this exact layout (`video_proof.py:142-153, 218-228`), so $E^* = E_h$. □

M. Completeness

An accepted attempt satisfies $B_1 z - ct_1 = B_1 y + cB_1 r - cB_1 r = w$, and for the equality proof $\langle b_2, z_a - z_b\rangle - c(t_{2,a} - t_{2,b}) = \langle b_2, y_a - y_b\rangle$ because $t_{2,a} - t_{2,b} = \langle b_2, r_a - r_b\rangle$ for equal messages. By Lemma 2 the number of attempts is geometric with parameter p_{acc} (mean 5.23) for the opening proof and p_{acc}^2 (mean 27.4) for the equality proof. With the caps $A_{\max} = 512$ (`opening_proof.py:33`) and $A_{\max} = 4\,096$ (`equality_proof.py:50`) the prover fails with probability $2^{-156.7}$ and $2^{-220.0}$ respectively. Under the shared cap of 512 that the reviewed code used, the equality proof failed with probability $2^{-35.0}$ for `bdlop-open-128-v1` (means 4.65 and 21.6); this is item D4.

APPENDIX B
SPECIFICATION AND IMPLEMENTATION CROSS-CHECK

Each item lists the property relied on above and where the implementation realizes it, at commit `ea96d60`. Paths are relative to `VideoLevel/src`; `opening_proof.py`, `equality_proof.py`, `bdlop.py`, `params.py`, `ring.py`, `codec.py`, `sampling.py`, `video_proof.py`, `video_pipeline.py` and `cli.py` are in `lattice_zk/`.

1) *Statement.* Field order and widths: `u16` version, rid, pid, root, `u64` epoch, N_s, codec policy, carrier profile, `u64` carrier count, positions hash, V; every digest checked to be 32 bytes (`video_proof.py:58-77`). Matches the specification, §3.6. **Consistent.**
2) *Fiat–Shamir input.* SHAKE-256 over the tag, pid, $\mathtt{u64}(|x|)\|x$, the full commitment (6 720 bytes) and w as big-endian 64-bit words; 32-byte output (`opening_proof.py:42-50`). Only x is length-prefixed; the other fields have lengths fixed by pid. Equality proof: same with both commitments and (w_a, w_b, u) (`equality_proof.py:40-51`). **Consistent**; the specification's "with length prefixes" (§4.7) was imprecise and has been corrected.
3) *Hedging.* $K = \mathrm{SHA3}(e\|\text{length-prefixed } x, t, r)$ (`opening_proof.py:53-63, 99-100`). **Consistent** (see D7).
4) *Samplers.* Masks: exact uniform on $[-\gamma + 1, \gamma]$ (18-bit draws below $2\gamma = 2^{18}$, `sampling.py:60-66`); challenges: sign bits then Fisher–Yates with exact rejection, as in ML-DSA SampleInBall (`:69-81`); ternary randomness by rejection on 2-bit draws (`:54-57`). **Consistent** with the uniformity used in Lemmas 2 and 6.
5) *Verification.* Exact proof length, packed responses below $2B + 1$, zero padding, recomputed w', constant-time seed comparison (`opening_proof.py:118-138`). The packing has no padding bits at these parameters, so the proof encoding is canonical. **Consistent.**
6) *Parameter checks.* Prime $q \equiv 5 \pmod 8$, $2\sqrt{2} < \sqrt{q}$, $2 \cdot 8\kappa B < q$ (`params.py:37-54`, `ring.py:52-58`); production pins require $|\mathcal{C}| \geq 2^{256}$ (`params.py:127-130`, `video_pipeline.py:144-145`). **Consistent.**
7) *Envelope.* In-band: exact length, magic `ZKLB`, version, pinned pid, canonical commitment ($< q$ per coefficient), proof (`video_proof.py:142-153`); the header session must equal the statement's (`:183`). Registered: `ZKLR`, header and proof only, pinned commitment (`:218-244`). **Consistent** with §3.7.
8) *Sessions.* One-use semantics as in the proof of Theorem 4; binding bind(pins) hashes pid, rid, root, epoch, codec policy and profile (`video_pipeline.py:166-172`), so in registered mode it also depends on the credential through rid. Stateless mode requires an explicit `expected_session` (`:262-263`). **Consistent.**
9) *Registry.* ML-DSA-65 over a tagged canonical JSON encoding; the registered descriptor hashes the key and the credential (`video_pipeline.py:109-131`, `zkp_registry.py:128-147`). **Consistent**, but see D2.
10) *Canonical digest.* As described in Section VI-J; the specification (§3.6) described D as a single-stream digest and has been corrected to the segmented form.
11) *Domain tags.* SHAKE-256 tags

`.../bdlop-open/v1/{key, randomness, fiat-shamir, mask}\0`, `.../bdlop-equal/v1/{fiat-shamir, mask}\0` and `.../challenge-poly/v1\0` each end in the only NUL byte and are pairwise distinct, hence prefix-free. **Consistent.**

A. Discrepancies and gaps

D1 (medium): carrier bits are malleable with a single chunk. `video_pipeline.py:267-303` accept a one-chunk set for any `chunk_size` in $[|E|, 65\,535]$, and the verifier never compares the extracted chunking with the pinned `profile.chunk_bytes` (`video_pipeline.py:267-303`). When the profile's chunk size is at least the envelope length, an adversary can rewrite the 16-bit field and the outer CRC-32: up to 48 carrier coefficients change by ± 1 while E, P and D are unchanged, and the video is accepted. Rewriting 8 000 to 20 000 changed 21 carrier bits in a direct test of the framing functions. This contradicts goal (iii) of the threat model ("any change to the carriers is rejected"). Fix: the verifier recomputes $\mathsf{Enc}_{\mathsf{prof}}(E)$, the chunks of E under the pinned chunk size, and requires it to equal the extracted pieces (or requires the header field to equal the pinned size); add a negative test.

D2 (medium): no holder identity in the signed registry descriptor. `video_pipeline.py:109-131`; field set `zkp_registry.py:29-35`) binds a credential commitment, not a holder. "Only the credential holder can produce the proof" holds per commitment; which person that is is not covered by the ML-DSA signature. Fix: add a holder identifier (or its digest) to the registered descriptor.

D3 (medium): disclosure hands over the commitment randomness (`video_proof.py:84-89,188-197`). The recipient can then produce fresh opening proofs for that commitment on new statements, i.e. accepted in-band videos with the creator's commitment, or impersonate a holder if a credential is disclosed. Fix: disclose p with the equality proof against $(0, \mathsf{enc}(p))$ and zero randomness, bound to a disclosure context (proof above).

D4 (low): equality-proof completeness 2^{-35}. `equality_proof.py:26-28` reuses $A_{\max} = 512$ with acceptance p_{acc}^2 (figures for `bdlop-open-128-v1`, the set reviewed; $2^{-27.5}$ for `bdlop-open-128-v2`). Fix: a separate cap, e.g. 4 096 attempts ($\approx 2^{-280}$ for v1, 2^{-220} for v2); a larger cap does not affect zero knowledge because acceptance is witness-independent.

D5 (low): scope of the canonical digest. `blind_sync_streaming.py:117-215`); segments without carriers are hashed as raw files without a domain tag (`:236-241,358,549`); RBSP bits after the stop bit of a carrier-bearing IDR NAL unit are excluded (`video_canonicalization.py: 279, 303, 310-317`); carrier blocks are hashed as level vectors; the codec policy string (`video_pipeline.py:25,98-99`) does not pin the segmenter version. None breaks Theorem 7, but each widens the set of unbound changes listed in Section VI-J. Fix: tag the raw-segment digests, hash the full RBSP of carrier NAL units, and pin or replace the segmenter.

D6 (low): API does not tie pins to the credential. `verify_video_proof` accepts `pins` and `credential` separately (`video_pipeline.py:250-265`) and does not check that `pins.relation_id` is the relation of that credential. The CLI derives both together (`cli.py:98-107`), but a caller that pins one credential and passes another verifies an unregistered credential. Fix: recompute the descriptor of `credential` and compare relation identifiers inside `verify_video_proof`.

D7 (info): hedging hash has no domain tag. `opening_proof.py:50` hashes $k \| m \| e \| \ldots$ directly. Separation from the tagged SHA3-256 uses relies on e being uniform; add a tag.

D8 (info): unreduced coefficients. `commitment.py:50` without `from_bytes` may hold coefficients in $[q, 2^{30})$, which `pack_uints` accepts (`codec.py:10-16`). Envelopes are unaffected (their decoder checks $< q$); pinned credentials loaded by other code paths are. Fix: range check in `Commitment`.

D9 (info): one global key. `params.py:133-149`); all users share one M-SIS/M-LWE instance, so precomputation against it amortizes.

D10 (info): `verify_statement_binding` hard-codes the `lazer-v1` suite (`zkp_registry.py:206-210`) and cannot serve `bdlop-open-v1`; the BDLOP path uses `pins_from_registry`.

D11 (info): §4.5 specification wording. as $(t_1, t_2) \mapsto (t_1 - B'_{1,2} t_2, t_2)$; the correct map uses $t_2 - m$ (Lemma 7). Corrected. §4.2 cites an "ML-DSA specification, Appendix B" for the zero-knowledge argument; this reference should be checked.

a) Status after the review.: D1–D4 and D6 are fixed in the code evaluated in Section VIII, each with a negative test: the verifier compares the extracted chunks with the canonical chunking of E under the pinned chunk size (D1); the registered descriptor can bind a holder-identifier digest (D2); disclosure is the zero-randomness equality proof of Section VI-E and the randomness-revealing API was removed (D3); the equality proof has its own 4 096-attempt cap (D4); and `verify_video_proof` recomputes the relation identifier of the supplied parameters, profile, credential and holder identifier and refuses mismatching pins (D6). D5, D7 and D8 and the reviewer question on production-strength enforcement are closed in a second round, again each with negative tests (`src/runtest/test_hardening_d5_d7_d8.py`). D7: the hedged mask key hashes a domain tag, the protocol label (opening, equality or binary proof) and the parameter

identifier before the entropy. Only `bdlop-open-128-v1` keeps the untagged derivation, so its known-answer vectors are unchanged; the `bdlop-open-128-v2` and binary-proof vectors were regenerated (commitments unchanged). The verifier never recomputes a mask, so proofs from either derivation verify, which the tests check. D8: a `Commitment` carries its parameter set and its constructor rejects coefficients outside $[0, q)$ and wrong shapes, storing read-only copies; verifiers still re-check objects built around the constructor. Production strength: every application-level verifier (`verify_video_proof`, the envelope, disclosure and linkage verifiers, and `pins_from_registry`) refuses a parameter set with a challenge space below 2^{256} unless the caller sets `allow_toy_parameters`; hand-built pins with the toy set are refused. D5 is closed by a new, opt-in codec policy (v2) with its own identifier, so it changes profile, policy, relation and statement identifiers, while codec policy v1 stays byte-identical for existing videos (recorded identifiers and digests are tested). Under v2 (a) a segment without carriers is hashed with a domain tag and its length and every segment digest is typed in the combined digest; (b) a carrier-bearing IDR NAL unit is hashed over its complete RBSP with its length, so zero bits after the stop bit are bound (under v1 a zero byte appended there is accepted; under v2 it is rejected, through the real H.264 transport); (c) the segmentation is pinned: the segments must be exactly the access-unit partition of the input, compared byte for byte, so the digest is a function of the input alone and a segmenter that cuts elsewhere fails closed. A registered `bdlop-open-128-v2` run on a 200-frame CIF cut under v2 verified from the video alone, and the replayed session, a one-bit change and the zero-extended carrier NAL unit were rejected (`benchmark/results/q2/hardening_e2e_container_cif_200f_v2.json`). The ffmpeg version is not hashed, because that would bind the verifier's installation rather than the video. Carrier blocks are still hashed as level vectors, which is what lets the proof bind the video without depending on its own bits. D9–D11 remain as described.

APPENDIX C
PROVING THAT A COMMITMENT HIDES A BINARY STRING

The opening proof shows knowledge of *some* relaxed opening and says nothing about the message. This section adds a proof Π_{bin} that a commitment $C = \mathsf{Com}(m; r) = (t_1, t_2)$ of the base scheme hides $m \in \{0,1\}^N$, i.e. a 256-bit string. C is unchanged, so the opening, equality and disclosure proofs still apply to it.

A. Setting and linearization

Notation is that of Section VI-A. Write $\langle a, b\rangle = \sum_j a_j b_j$ for coefficient vectors, $\mathrm{ct}(a) = a_0$, $a \circ b$ for the coefficient-wise product, $J = \sum_{j<N} X^j$ and $\sigma \in \mathrm{Aut}(\mathcal{R}_q)$ for $X \mapsto X^{-1}$. Because $q \equiv 5 \pmod 8$, $\mathcal{R}_q \cong \mathbb{F}_{q^{N/2}} \times \mathbb{F}_{q^{N/2}}$; there are only two CRT slots, so the ring-level relation $m(m-1) = 0$ of ALS20 [27] would constrain only two bits. Following the constant-coefficient technique of LNP22 [29], we instead linearize the coefficient-wise relation $m \circ (m - J) = 0$.

Lemma 9 (Linearization)**.** *For all $a, b \in \mathcal{R}_q$: (i) $\mathrm{ct}(\sigma(a)b) = \langle a, b\rangle$; (ii) σ is an involution and $\langle \sigma(a), b\rangle = \langle a, \sigma(b)\rangle$; (iii) for $\gamma, \rho \in \mathbb{Z}_q^N$, $u \in \mathcal{R}_q$ and $R = \sigma(\gamma \circ \sigma(\rho))$,*

$$\mathrm{ct}\big(\sigma(\rho)u - Rm\big) = \langle \rho,\, u - \sigma(\gamma \circ m)\rangle, \qquad \mathrm{ct}\big(\sigma(\gamma\circ m)(m-J)\big) = \langle \gamma,\, m \circ (m$$

(iv) Any quadratic form $\mathbb{Z}_q^N \to \mathbb{Z}_q$ of the shape $m \mapsto \mathrm{ct}(\sum_\ell a_\ell\, \tau_\ell(m)\, b_\ell\, \tau'_\ell(m))$ with $a_\ell, b_\ell \in \mathcal{R}_q$ and $\tau_\ell, \tau'_\ell \in \{\mathrm{id}, \sigma\}$ is $m^{\mathsf{T}} T_w m$ for a negacyclic Toeplitz T_w, whose diagonal is $w_0 I$.

Proof. (i) The constant coefficient of $\sigma(a)b$ collects $a_0 b_0$ and, for $i \geq 1$, $(-a_i)X^{N-i} \cdot b_i X^i = a_i b_i$. (ii) σ acts on coefficient vectors as a symmetric signed permutation. (iii) follows from (i) and (ii). (iv) Multiplication by a is T_a, σ is the signed permutation S with $S T_a S = T_{\sigma(a)}$, and $T_a^{\mathsf{T}} = T_{\sigma(a)}$; products and sums of negacyclic Toeplitz matrices are negacyclic Toeplitz. □

Item (iv) is why the prover must commit to the *lifts* $u_i = \sigma(\gamma_i \circ m)$ once γ_i is known: a random diagonal form $\sum_j \gamma_j m_j^2$ is not reachable from m alone.

B. The protocol

Let k (lift repetitions) and k' (check repetitions) be parameters ($k = k' = 5$). An auxiliary BDLOP key $\mathsf{ck}' = (B'_1, (b'_j)_j)$ with $B'_1 = [I_n \,|\, \cdot] \in \mathcal{R}_q^{n \times k_{\mathrm{aux}}}$, $b'_j = [0^n \,|\, e_j \,|\, \cdot]$, $k_{\mathrm{aux}} = n + (k + k' + 1) + \lambda$, is expanded from the parameter identifier. In each proof the prover samples a *fresh* $r' \in S_1^{k_{\mathrm{aux}}}$. The interactive protocol is:

1) V: $\gamma_1, \ldots, \gamma_k \leftarrow \mathbb{Z}_q^N$.
2) P: $u_i = \sigma(\gamma_i \circ m)$, $g_t \leftarrow \{g \in \mathcal{R}_q : \mathrm{ct}(g) = 0\}$; send $D = (B'_1 r', \langle b'_{u_i}, r'\rangle + u_i,\ \langle b'_{g_t}, r'\rangle + g_t)$.
3) V: $\rho_{t,i} \leftarrow \mathbb{Z}_q^N$, $\mu_{t,i} \leftarrow \mathbb{Z}_q$.
4) P: send $h_t = g_t + E_t$ for $E_t = \sum_i \sigma(\rho_{t,i}) u_i - R_{t,i} m + \mu_{t,i} u_i (m - J)$, $R_{t,i} = \sigma(\gamma_i \circ \sigma(\rho_{t,i}))$. V requires $\mathrm{ct}(h_t) = 0$.
5) V: $\alpha_t \leftarrow \mathcal{R}_q$. Both sides form $P(s) = \sum_t \alpha_t (g_t + E_t - h_t) = \psi m + L(s) - H$, with $\psi = \sum_i \beta_i u_i$, $\beta_i = \sum_t \alpha_t \mu_{t,i}$, L linear and $H = \sum_t \alpha_t h_t$.
6) P: masks $y \leftarrow Y$, $y' \leftarrow Y'$; with a_j the projections $\langle b_j, y\rangle$ resp. $\langle b'_j, y'\rangle$ and $\Gamma_1 = -(\psi a_m + a_\psi m + L(a))$, commit $t_G = \langle b'_G, r'\rangle + \Gamma_1$ and announce $(t_G, w = B_1 y, w' = B'_1 y', v = a_\psi a_m + a_G)$.
7) V: $c \leftarrow \mathcal{C}$. P: $z = y + cr$, $z' = y' + cr'$; abort unless both lie in $[-B, B]$.
8) V accepts iff $B_1 z = w + c t_1$, $B'_1 z' = w' + c t'_1$ and, with masked openings $f_j = c t_j - \langle b_j, z\rangle$,

$$v = f_\psi f_m + c\,\big(L(f) - cH\big) - f_G.$$

Honestly $f_j = c s_j - a_j$, so the right-hand side equals $c^2 P(s) + c(\Gamma_1 - \Gamma_1) + a_\psi a_m + a_G = v$. The non-interactive version derives the four challenges from chained, domain-separated SHAKE-256 seeds over (pid, x, C), D, $(h_t)_t$ and (t_G, w, w', v) in this order; on an abort only steps 6–7 are repeated. The proof is $(D, (h_t)_t, t_G, seed, z, z')$; for `bdlop-binary-128-v2` it is 43 022 bytes.

C. Security

Theorem 8 (Completeness)**.** *If $C = \mathsf{Com}(m; r)$ with $m \in \{0,1\}^N$ and $r \in S_1^k$, an attempt is accepted with probability exactly $p_{\mathrm{acc}} = ((2B+1)/2\gamma)^{(k+k_{\mathrm{aux}})N}$ (0.0112 for* `bdlop-binary-128-v2`*), every accepted transcript verifies, and the prover fails to output a proof within $A_{\max} = 16\,384$ attempts with probability $(1-p_{\mathrm{acc}})^{A_{\max}} < 2^{-266}$.*

Proof. $\mathrm{ct}(E_t) = 0$ by Lemma 9(iii) with $u_i = \sigma(\gamma_i \circ m)$ and $m \circ (m - J) = 0$, so $\mathrm{ct}(h_t) = 0$. $P(s) = 0$ by construction, and the verification identity is the computation above. Acceptance is the uniform-masking argument of Lemma 2 applied to the $(k + k_{\mathrm{aux}})N$ coefficients of (z, z'), using $\|cr\|_\infty, \|cr'\|_\infty \le \kappa$. □

Lemma 10 (Consistent masked openings)**.** *Let three accepting transcripts share the messages of steps 1–6 and have pairwise distinct challenges c, c', c''. Then either one obtains a nonzero x with $B_1 x = 0$ or $B_1' x = 0$ and $\|x\|_\infty \le 8\kappa B$, or there are $\bar{f} \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$, relaxed openings $(\bar{r}, \bar{f})$ of C and $(\bar{r}', \bar{f})$ of D with messages $\bar{m}, \bar{s}$, and vectors $y^\star, y'^\star$ such that $z = y^\star + c\bar{f}^{-1}\bar{r}$ (likewise for z') for all three transcripts. Consequently $v = c^2 P(\bar{s}) + cX + Y$ for fixed $X, Y \in \mathcal{R}_q$ and all three challenges, and $P(\bar{s}) = 0$.*

Proof sketch. The first two transcripts give relaxed openings with $\bar{f} = c - c'$ and $\bar{r} = z - z'$, $\bar{r}' = z'_{(1)} - z'_{(2)}$, as in Lemma 6 and the equality proof (Lemma 8). Put $y_c^\star = z_c - c\bar{f}^{-1}\bar{r}$; then $B_1 y_c^\star = w$ for every accepting c, and $\bar{f}(y_c^\star - y_{c''}^\star) = \bar{f}(z_c - z_{c''}) - (c - c'')\bar{r}$ is a vector of norm at most $2\kappa \cdot 2B + 2\kappa \cdot 2B = 8\kappa B$ in the kernel of B_1; it is zero unless it is an M-SIS solution, and then $y^\star$ is independent of c because $\bar{f}$ is invertible (Lemma 1). The same holds for B_1'. Substituting into f_j gives $f_j = c\bar{s}_j - \bar{a}_j$ with $\bar{a}_j$ independent of c, so the verification equation is a polynomial identity of degree two in c with leading coefficient $P(\bar{s})$. Subtracting it at c, c' and c', c'' and using the invertibility of $c - c'$, $c' - c''$ and $c - c''$ gives $P(\bar{s}) = 0$. □

Theorem 9 (Round-by-round soundness)**.** *Let C be a commitment whose relaxed-opening message $\bar{m}$ (unique by Theorem 2) is not binary. For any prover of the interactive protocol, the probability that the verifier accepts and no M-SIS solution for B_1 or B_1' of norm $\le 8\kappa B$ is found is at most*

$$\varepsilon_{\mathsf{rbr}} = q^{-k} + q^{-k'} + q^{-N/2} + 2/|\mathcal{C}|,$$

and each of the four challenge rounds individually contributes at most the corresponding term. For `bdlop-binary-128-v2`*, $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{rbr}} \le 2^{-149.99}$.*

Proof sketch. Fix the extracted messages; they are determined by C and D up to M-SIS (binding with respect to relaxed openings, for both keys). *Lift round.* Let $\Delta_i = \bar{u}_i - \sigma(\gamma_i \circ \bar{m})$, $Q_i = \mathrm{ct}(\bar{u}_i(\bar{m} - J))$ and $e = (\Delta_i, Q_i)_i$. If $e = 0$ then $Q_i = \langle \gamma_i, \bar{m} \circ (\bar{m} - J) \rangle = 0$ for all i by Lemma 9(iii); since $\bar{m}$ is fixed before γ and $\bar{m} \circ (\bar{m} - J) \neq 0$, this has probability q^{-k}, whatever D the prover sends afterwards. *Check round.* By Lemma 9, $\mathrm{ct}(\bar{g}_t + E_t(\bar{s})) = \delta_t + \varphi_t(e)$ with $\delta_t = \mathrm{ct}(\bar{g}_t)$ and $\varphi_t(e) = \sum_i \langle \rho_{t,i}, \Delta_i \rangle + \mu_{t,i} Q_i$. Both $e \neq 0$ and δ_t are fixed by D before (ρ, μ) is drawn, and $\varphi_t(e)$ is uniform on $\mathbb{Z}_q$ for each t, independently; hence $\delta_t + \varphi_t(e) = 0$ for all t with probability $q^{-k'}$. Otherwise some t has $\mathrm{ct}(\bar{g}_t + E_t) \neq 0 = \mathrm{ct}(h_t)$, i.e. $\bar{P}_t = \bar{g}_t + E_t - h_t \neq 0$. *Combine round.* The $\bar{P}_t$ are fixed before α. In a CRT slot $\mathbb{F}_{q^{N/2}}$ where some $\bar{P}_{t_0} \neq 0$, $\sum_t \alpha_t \bar{P}_t$ is uniform, so it vanishes with probability $q^{-N/2}$. *Challenge round.* If $P(\bar{s}) \neq 0$, pick a slot ϕ where it is nonzero. The polynomial $c^2 P(\bar{s}) + cX + Y - v$ is nonzero of degree two modulo ϕ, so it has at most two roots in the field $\mathcal{R}_q/\phi$; as $c - c'$ is invertible for distinct challenges, $c \mapsto c \bmod \phi$ is injective on $\mathcal{C}$, and at most two challenges are roots. By Lemma 10 an accepting transcript needs a root. □

a) The non-interactive proof.: Write $H_1, \ldots, H_4$ for the four domain-separated oracles (lift, check, combine, challenge), modelled as independent random oracles, and $\varepsilon_1 = q^{-k}$, $\varepsilon_2 = q^{-k'}$, $\varepsilon_3 = q^{-N/2}$, $\varepsilon_4 = 2/|\mathcal{C}|$ for the four terms of Theorem 9 (we model $c = \mathsf{SampleInBall}(H_4(\cdot))$ as uniform on $\mathcal{C}$). The seeds are chained: the input of H_{i+1} contains the output s_i of H_i. For a relaxed opening with messages $\bar{s}$ of the rows hashed into an H_i-query, call the answer of that query *bad* if it is the bad event of round i in the proof of Theorem 9: all $\langle \gamma_i, \bar{v} \rangle = 0$ while $\bar{v} = \bar{m} \circ (\bar{m} - J) \neq 0$ $(i = 1)$; $\delta_t + \varphi_t(e) = 0$ for all t while $e \neq 0$ $(i = 2)$; $\sum_t \alpha_t \bar{P}_t = 0$ while some $\bar{P}_t \neq 0$ $(i = 3)$. Each of these depends only on the query input (it contains C, the rows of D sent so far, $(h_t)_t$ and, through the chained seed, the earlier challenges) and on the answer, and for every fixed $\bar{s}$ it has probability at most ε_i over the answer.

Theorem 10 (Knowledge soundness of the non-interactive proof)**.** *Let $\mathcal{A}$ make at most Q queries to $H_1, \ldots, H_4$ in total and output (x, C, π) that the verifier accepts with probability ε. There is an extractor $\mathcal{E}$ that runs $\mathcal{A}$ an expected number of at most $3 + 2Q$ times, and for $i = 1, 2, 3$ an algorithm $\mathcal{F}_i$ that runs $\mathcal{E}$ twice, such that $\mathcal{E}$ outputs a relaxed opening of C whose message is binary with probability at least*

$$\varepsilon - (Q+1)\sum_{i=1}^{4} \varepsilon_i - \sum_{i=1}^{3} \sqrt{(Q+1)\,\alpha_i} - \beta - \frac{Q^2}{2^{256}},$$

where β (resp. α_i) is the probability that $\mathcal{E}$ (resp. $\mathcal{F}_i$) outputs an M-SIS solution of ℓ_∞ norm at most $8\kappa B$ for B_1 or B_1'. In particular, if C has no relaxed opening with a binary message, then $\varepsilon \le (Q+1)\varepsilon_{\mathsf{rbr}} + \sum_i \sqrt{(Q+1)\alpha_i} + \beta + Q^2 2^{-256}$ with $\varepsilon_{\mathsf{rbr}} \le 2^{-149.99}$ for `bdlop-binary-128-v2`*.*

Proof sketch. Aborts. The prover repeats only steps 6–7 after an abort; the seeds s_1, s_2, s_3, the commitment D and the masks $(h_t)_t$ are fixed before the first attempt. To the verifier and to a cheating prover, a rejected attempt is an H_4-query whose answer is discarded, so it is counted in Q and needs no further treatment for soundness. (For zero knowledge, rounds 1–3 never abort, so the simulator obtains $\gamma, \rho, \mu, \alpha$ by plain oracle queries on its simulated D and h, and only the aborting last round is simulated by programming H_4, exactly as for the opening proof in Lemma 3, following [44], [45].)

Query order. Without loss of generality $\mathcal{A}$ queries the four oracle inputs of its output (one more query each). Because the input of H_{i+1} contains the 256-bit output of H_i, except

with probability $Q^2/2^{256}$ these four queries occur in the order H_1, H_2, H_3, H_4 and the H_4-query is the last of them.

The last round. Fix $\mathcal{A}$'s coins and the answers to all queries before the critical H_4-query. Its input fixes the prefix $pre = (x, C, D, (h_t)_t, s_3)$ and the announcement (t_G, w, w', v), and the remaining protocol is a Σ-protocol for the statement pre with challenge c and response (z, z'). By Lemma 10 it is 3-special sound for the relation "relaxed openings of C and D with a common $\bar{f} \in \bar{\mathcal{C}}$ whose messages satisfy $P_{pre}(\bar{s}) = 0$, or an $\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}$ solution of norm $\leq 8\kappa B$". The Fiat–Shamir extractor of Attema, Fehr and Kloß [57] for k-special-sound Σ-protocols ($k = 3$; it rewinds only the critical query of the challenge oracle and treats the statement and every other oracle as part of $\mathcal{A}$) runs $\mathcal{A}$ an expected $k+Q(k-1) = 3+2Q$ times and succeeds with probability at least $(\varepsilon - (Q+1)\varepsilon_4)/(1-\varepsilon_4) \geq \varepsilon - (Q+1)\varepsilon_4$.

The statistical rounds. If $\mathcal{E}$ outputs openings with messages $\bar{s}$ and none of the three round challenges of the output is bad for $\bar{s}$, the chain of Theorem 9 applies verbatim: a non-binary $\bar{m}$ would give $P_{pre}(\bar{s}) \neq 0$. It remains to bound the event Bad_i that the round-i challenge is bad for the extracted $\bar{s}$. The difficulty is that $\bar{s}$ is extracted *after* the challenge and is fixed by the earlier rows only computationally (binding w.r.t. relaxed openings). Fix $j \leq Q$ and everything before the j-th H_i-query (the "prefix"); let ξ be the rest of the randomness of $\mathcal{E}$, including the answer $\gamma^{(j)}$ to that query. For each message vector m of the rows hashed into the query let $p_m = \Pr_\xi[\mathcal{E}$ outputs openings, the output uses query $j, \bar{s}|_{\text{rows}} = m]$, $P = \sum_m p_m$, and let $m^\star$ maximise p_m; $m^\star$ depends on the prefix only, hence is independent of $\gamma^{(j)}$. Then

$$\Pr_\xi[\mathsf{Bad}_i \wedge \text{query } j] \leq \Pr[\gamma^{(j)} \text{ bad for } m^\star] + \Pr_\xi[\bar{s}|_{\text{rows}} \neq m^\star] \leq \varepsilon_i + (P - p_{m^\star}).$$

$\mathcal{F}_i$ runs $\mathcal{E}$, and if the output uses the j-th H_i-query it reruns $\mathcal{E}$ from that query with fresh ξ'; it succeeds if both runs use query j and their messages on the hashed rows differ. Two relaxed openings $(\bar{r}, \bar{f})$, $(\bar{r}', \bar{f}')$ of the same t_1 (or t_1') with different messages give the $\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}$ solution $\bar{f}'\bar{r} - \bar{f}\bar{r}' \neq 0$ of norm $\leq 8\kappa B$, as in Theorem 2. Given the prefix, the success probability is $P^2 - \sum_m p_m^2 \geq P(P - p_{m^\star}) \geq (P - p_{m^\star})^2$. Summing over j, with Jensen's and the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality, $\sum_j \mathbb{E}[P - p_{m^\star}] \leq \sqrt{(Q+1)\alpha_i}$, so $\Pr[\mathsf{Bad}_i] \leq (Q+1)\varepsilon_i + \sqrt{(Q+1)\alpha_i}$. Collecting the terms gives the bound. □

Status and remaining gaps. This closes the composition that earlier drafts left open: aborts touch only the last round, the statistical rounds lose the usual factor $Q+1$ of round-by-round soundness [58], and only the last oracle is forked. What remains is (i) the $\mathsf{M\text{-}SIS}$ terms $\sqrt{(Q+1)\alpha_i}$, which carry the same square-root (forking) loss as the opening proof (Lemma 6) and make the reduction non-tight; (ii) the use of the Attema–Fehr–Kloß Σ-protocol bound with a statement (the prefix) chosen adaptively by $\mathcal{A}$ through other oracles, which we believe is covered by their adaptive formulation but have not checked line by line; (iii) the modelling of $\mathsf{SampleInBall} \circ H_4$ as a uniform challenge (the seed has 256 bits and $|\mathcal{C}| = 2^{257}$); and (iv) a classical-ROM argument only, as for every theorem here. The proof is a sketch and has not been checked independently.

Theorem 11 (Honest-verifier zero knowledge)**.** *There is a simulator that, given (x, C) only and programming the random oracle at four points, outputs proofs whose distribution differs from honest proofs by at most $\mathsf{Adv}^{\mathsf{M\text{-}LWE}}_{\mathsf{aux}}$ (hiding of the auxiliary instance: secret rank λ, $n+k+k'+1$ ring samples, ternary secret and error) plus the programming-collision terms of Lemma 3, for any number of proofs on the same C.*

Proof sketch. (1) Accepted (z, z') are uniform on $[-B, B]^{(k+k_{\text{aux}})N}$ and independent of (r, r') (Lemma 2); sample them directly and program the oracles, the announcement having min-entropy through w and w'. (2) t_G's message Γ_1 is a function of z', c, the public rows of D and the witness (since $a_j = \langle b_j', z' \rangle - c(t_j' - s_j)$), so a reduction that knows m but not r' can produce D and t_G from an $\mathsf{M\text{-}LWE}$ challenge for ck'; replace them by uniform values. (3) Then g_t occurs only in h_t, which is uniform on $\{\text{ct} = 0\}$; the simulator samples h_t there. The verification equations determine w, w', v. The base randomness r is used across proofs only through rejection-sampled responses, and r' is fresh in each proof, so the hybrids compose over many proofs. □

D. Binding the proof to the payload encoding

Π_{bin} applies to a commitment of a 256-bit string, whereas the payload commitments of Section VI-A encode $\text{len}(p) \,\|\, p$ with three bytes per coefficient. A variant Π_{pay} (`payload_range_proof.py`, set `bdlop-payload-range-128-v1`) proves a statement about the payload commitment itself.

a) Statement.: Public input (x, L, C) with C an unchanged base commitment and a public length $L \leq 128$ bytes. Write $\text{Enc}(p) = e_L + A\beta(p)$, where $\beta(p) \in \{0,1\}^{\ell N}$ are the bits of p (most significant first, $\ell = \lceil 8L/N \rceil$ binary polynomials β_j), $e_L = \text{Enc}(0^L)$ carries the length field, and A is the public $\mathbb{Z}_q$-linear map that sends payload bit s to coefficient $\lfloor (2 + \lfloor s/8 \rfloor)/3 \rfloor$ with weight $2^{8(2-(2+\lfloor s/8 \rfloor) \bmod 3)+7-s \bmod 8}$. Π_{pay} proves knowledge of a relaxed opening of C whose message is $\text{Enc}(p)$ for some $p \in \{0,1\}^{8L}$: every coefficient lies in $[0, 2^{24})$ and is the packing of payload bytes, coefficient 0 carries L, and all coefficients beyond $\lceil (L+2)/3 \rceil$ vanish. It reveals L and nothing else about p.

b) Protocol.: It is Π_{bin} with three changes. (1) The binary polynomials live in the first ℓ slots of the auxiliary commitment D, whose rows $D_0 = (t_1', t_{\beta_j})$ are hashed into H_1 together with (pid, x, L, C); the lifts and masks are added afterwards as further rows of D under the same randomness r'. (2) There are k lifts per binary polynomial, $u_{j,i} = \sigma(\gamma_{j,i} \circ \beta_j)$. (3) Each check functional gets a link term with a fresh $\rho_t^L \in \mathbb{Z}_q^N$: E_t gains $\sigma(\rho_t^L)m - \sum_j \sigma(A_j^\intercal \rho_t^L)\beta_j - \langle \rho_t^L, e_L \rangle$, whose constant coefficient is $\langle \rho_t^L, m - A\beta - e_L \rangle$ by Lemma 9(i). The combined relation is $\sum_j \psi_j \beta_j + L(s) - H' = 0$ with $\psi_j = \sum_i \beta_{j,i} u_{j,i}$, proved with one garbage polynomial as before.

Theorem 12 (Payload range proof)**.** *Completeness holds as in Theorem 8 with $k_{\text{aux}} = n + \ell(k+1) + k' + 1 + \lambda$*

(acceptance 0.0100 *for* $\ell = 1$*,* 0.0012 *for* $\ell = 4$*; cap* 2^{17} *attempts). Theorems 9 and 10 hold for* Π_{pay} *with the same four round errors and with "binary message" replaced by "message* $\mathrm{Enc}(p)$ *for some* $p \in \{0,1\}^{8L}$*". Zero knowledge holds as in Theorem 11; the simulator is given* (x, L, C)*.*

Proof sketch. Lift round: if some $\bar{\beta}_j$ is not binary, the k functionals $\langle \gamma_{j,i}, \bar{\beta}_j \circ (\bar{\beta}_j - J) \rangle$ all vanish with probability q^{-k}, as $\bar{\beta}$ is fixed by D_0 before γ. Check round: the error vector e now also contains $e_{\mathrm{link}} = \bar{m} - A\bar{\beta} - e_L$, which is fixed by C and D_0 before ρ^L, and $\varphi_t(e)$ gains $\langle \rho_t^L, e_{\mathrm{link}} \rangle$; it stays uniform when $e \neq 0$. The combine and challenge rounds and the extraction are unchanged (Lemma 10 for C and D). If no bad event occurs, $\bar{\beta}$ is binary and $\bar{m} = A\bar{\beta} + e_L$ holds in $\mathbb{Z}_q^N$; since $A\bar{\beta} + e_L$ has integer coefficients below $2^{24} < q$, $\bar{m}$ is exactly $\mathrm{Enc}(p)$ for the p whose bits are the first $8L$ entries of $\bar{\beta}$. □

For `bdlop-payload-range-128-v1` the proof has $44\,558$ bytes for $L \leq 32$ ($\ell = 1$) and grows by $9\,216$ bytes per further 32 payload bytes ($72\,206$ bytes at $L = 128$). The auxiliary M-SIS ($n \times 25$ to $n \times 43$) and M-LWE (18 to 36 samples) instances give the same pinned estimates as the base set (`research/bdlop_params/bdlop_payload_range_128_l{1,4}.estimate.bison`). Two alternatives are worse. Encoding the payload in binary from the start (one bit per coefficient) lets Π_{bin} apply directly, at $6\,720 + 43\,022$ bytes per 32 payload bytes, but needs a new envelope format and disclosure encoding. A range proof of all 256 payload coefficients ($\ell = 24$ bit-planes) would need 177 response polynomials, $256\,526$ bytes and an acceptance probability of $8 \cdot 10^{-10}$ per attempt with the fixed mask bound $\gamma = 2^{17}$, so it is impractical without a larger auxiliary mask bound and a new M-SIS estimate.

Remark 1 (Limits)**.** *The theorems are classical-ROM statements; no QROM claim is made. The auxiliary key's M-SIS (*$n \times 24$ *instead of* $n \times 14$*) and M-LWE (*17 *instead of* 7 *samples) instances give the same levels as the base set under the pinned estimator (M-SIS* $\beta = 480$*, 140/127 bits; primal M-LWE* $\beta = 580$*, 169/153 bits; dual* $\beta = 578$*), since the optimal M-SIS sub-dimension (*$\approx 3\,022$*) is below both widths (`research/bdlop_params/bdlop_binary_128_v2.estimate.bison`); the dual-hybrid caveat of Section V-D applies equally. The soundness error* 2^{-150} *per round is below the* 2^{-256} *of the opening proof;* $k = k' = 9$ *would match it at about 12 KB more.* Π_{pay} *makes the length* L *public and covers payloads of at most 128 bytes; a hidden length would need a proof that the bytes after an unknown length are zero, and statements about the payload* value *(beyond its encoding) are not proved, although any public affine constraint on the payload bits could be added as one more link functional.*

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